

Rapid #: -27483628

CROSS REF ID: **292268**

LENDER: **JANCC (National Cancer Center Japan) :: Main Library**

BORROWER: **IAT (Southern Illinois University at Edwardsville) :: Main Library**

TYPE: Article CC:CCG

JOURNAL TITLE: Journal of consumer behaviour

USER JOURNAL TITLE: Journal of consumer behaviour.

ARTICLE TITLE: Crafting Influence: A Systematic Review on Social Media Influencers Video Content

ARTICLE AUTHOR: Gupta, Shikha

VOLUME: 25

ISSUE: 5

MONTH:

YEAR: 2026

PAGES: 2414-2438

ISSN: 1472-0817

OCLC #: 49883766

Processed by RapidX: 9/16/2026 6:16:52 PM

This material may be protected by copyright law (Title 17 U.S. Code)

REVIEW

Crafting Influence: A Systematic Review on Social Media Influencers Video Content

Shikha Gupta¹  | Amit Singh² | Anuj Kapoor¹ 

¹School of Management and Entrepreneurship, Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Jodhpur, Jodhpur, India | ²Amrut Modi University, Ahmedabad University, Ahmedabad, India

Correspondence: Shikha Gupta (gupta.93@iitj.ac.in)

Received: 30 August 2024 | **Revised:** 29 April 2026 | **Accepted:** 7 May 2026

Keywords: short-form video | social media influencers | systematic literature review | TCCM framework | video

ABSTRACT

Social media influencers (SMIs) increasingly use video content as a persuasive tool, shaping consumer perceptions, attitudes, and behaviors in the digital marketplace. Despite this growing influence, research examining SMIs' video content and its impact on consumer behavior remains fragmented. To address this gap, the present study systematically reviews 112 peer-reviewed articles using the TCCM (Theory–Context–Characteristics–Method) framework, complemented by a multi-method approach that integrates topic modeling with in-depth interviews to identify underlying themes. Combining insights from academic literature and practitioner perspectives, this study offers a comprehensive understanding of how SMIs' video content influences consumer behavior. The findings reveal a sharp increase in publications since 2020, with YouTube and TikTok emerging as dominant platforms and China and the United States as key research contexts. Persuasion and parasocial interaction theories are the primary theoretical anchors, while trust, authenticity, and engagement consistently emerge as critical constructs. The field remains quantitative mainly, though interest in computational and multi-method approaches is growing. This literature review presents a thorough understanding of how SMIs' video content impacts consumer behavior and offers future research directions.

1 | Introduction

With the growing digitalization and internet penetration, social media platforms have become an integral part of our day-to-day lives. Currently, 67.9% of the global population is internet users, while 63.9% actively use various social media platforms (Statista 2025a). The widespread adoption lays the foundation for social media influencers (SMIs) to produce self-generated, engaging, and niche-oriented content (De Jans et al. 2018). Specifically, SMIs are individuals with sizable and engaged followings who can shape attitudes, opinions, and behaviors through their online content (Freberg et al. 2011). As a distinct subset of content creators, SMIs are characterized by their perceived authenticity, capacity for developing relational depth with audiences, and ability to generate meaningful consumer impact through their online presence (Salunke et al. 2025). Over the past decade, there has been significant growth in academic literature

on SMIs and their impact on consumer behavior (Harrigan et al. 2021; Ooi et al. 2023; Pradhan et al. 2023). SMIs leverage social proof, parasocial relationships, and perceived credibility to influence consumer decisions, with video content emerging as an effective tool (Boerman and van Reijmersdal 2020; Rohde and Mau 2021; Xiao et al. 2018). Reflecting their rising influence, the global influencer industry was valued at \$250 billion in 2024 and is projected to nearly double to \$480 billion by 2027 (Forbes 2025).

Social media influencers employ a diverse range of content formats including text-based posts, static images, audio, and videos to engage their audiences across platforms, with each format varying in its ability to capture attention, deliver experiential depth, and shape consumer behavior. However, video content stands apart, conveying information through a rich combination of audiovisual signals whose multimodal

complexity significantly influences users' cognition, emotions, and attitudes (Garrido-Pintado et al. 2022; Wang et al. 2023; Wei et al. 2022; Xiao et al. 2025). Unlike text, images, or audio, videos incorporate dynamic visual elements and movement that heighten the vividness of shared experiences and favorably shape audiences' product evaluations (Chen, Nguyen, et al. 2024; Chen, Chen, and Pan 2024; Ladhari et al. 2020; Liu et al. 2019). Consequently, video outperforms other formats in conveying experiential product characteristics and has been shown to surpass Instagram posts, tweets, and audio podcasts in driving audience attention and engagement (Chen, Nguyen, et al. 2024; Chen, Chen, and Pan 2024; Ladhari et al. 2020; Landsberg 2021). Beyond engagement, SMIs creating video content are perceived as more credible, authentic, and relatable, connecting meaningfully with their followers and emerging as powerful brand spokespeople in contemporary digital advertising (Arnold 2017; Chen et al. 2023; Harnish and Bridges 2016; Ladhari et al. 2020; Lee and Watkins 2016; O'Neil-Hart and Blumenstein 2016). Through immersive storytelling, visual, audio, and narrative elements collectively build emotional trust, shape purchase decisions, and strengthen symbolic brand attachment (Kim and Baek 2025; Lou and Yuan 2019). With over 3.3 billion people worldwide now consuming digital video (HubSpot 2024), influencer-driven video content has firmly established itself as a central pillar of contemporary social media advertising (Influencer Marketing Hub 2025a). Despite this growing prominence, the academic literature has yet to systematically examine how SMI video content shapes consumer behavior.

Recognising the growing importance of SMIs, several scholars have conducted systematic literature reviews exploring their impact on consumer behavior across various dimensions (Bhardwaj et al. 2024; Pushparaj and Kushwaha 2024; Spörl-Wang et al. 2025). As demonstrated in Table 1, existing reviews have examined SMIs through the lens of marketing effectiveness (Barari et al. 2025; Pan et al. 2025; Spörl-Wang et al. 2025), foundations and trends of influencer marketing (Joshi et al. 2025; Tanwar et al. 2022), endorsement (Salunke et al. 2025), purchase intention (Sardar and Vijay 2025), and niche influencer segments (Beuckels and de Wolf 2025), collectively advancing understanding of SMI credibility, authenticity, engagement, and consumer decision-making. However, while these reviews have addressed various aspects of SMI influence, to the best of the authors' knowledge, no systematic literature review has specifically focused on SMIs video content or examined the unique psychological mechanisms through which SMIs video content shapes consumer behavior. This is a significant gap, as individual studies on SMIs video content are steadily increasing but remain scattered across marketing, psychology, and communication disciplines, with no systematic review to map, consolidate, and theoretically organise this growing body of evidence. Addressing this gap is both timely and necessary.

Beyond the conceptual gap, existing work has relied on a narrow set of methods and broadening them would deepen understanding of how SMIs video content influences consumer behavior. Notably, integrating computational topic modeling with practitioner insights represents an underexplored methodological avenue that could bridge the gap between theoretical patterns and emerging industry practices. As Mukherjee et al. (2022)

highlight, systematic reviews must justify their need, relevance, and urgency by clearly linking insights with theoretical advancement and practical contribution, which further underscores the necessity of the present review. Consequently, there remains significant potential to deepen our understanding of how SMIs video content influences consumer behavior. Accordingly, given the central role of videos in digital content consumption and their strategic importance in SMI marketing, this study synthesises the existing literature on SMIs' video content to establish a clear theoretical and empirical foundation for future research. The review is guided by the following research questions:

RQ1. *How has the scholarly domain on SMIs' video content evolved in terms of intellectual foundations, publication patterns, and knowledge structures?*

RQ2. *What theories, contexts, characteristics, and methodological approaches are prevalent in the existing literature on SMIs' video content?*

RQ3. *What dominant themes emerge in the literature on SMIs' video content using topic modelling and in-depth interviews?*

RQ4. *What are the prevalent future research avenues concerning SMIs' video content?*

To address these research questions, the study adopts a framework-based literature review method. This approach highlights the field's evolution and identifies key research areas to guide future research directions. To address RQ1, the study examines publication trends, leading journals, and keyword co-occurrence networks. For RQ2 (theories, contexts, characteristics, and methodologies), the TCCM framework (Paul and Feliciano-Cestero 2021; Paul and Rosado-Serrano 2019) is used to systematically map theoretical foundations, research contexts (including themes and other contextual factors), key characteristics, and methodologies employed in existing studies. For RQ3, we identified themes using topic modelling, an advanced machine learning technique that systematically extracted latent patterns from the literature. We complemented this with in-depth interviews, and while Salunke et al. (2025) developed an evidence-based framework to assess SMIs' endorsements, our study advances this work by integrating computational techniques with qualitative insights to provide a more holistic understanding of SMIs' video research. Combining these approaches, we triangulate the findings to ensure methodological robustness and practical relevance. Finally, RQ4 (future research avenues) is addressed through insights derived from the TCCM framework, synthesizing trends, thematic developments, and methodological progress to propose future research directions. Through this multi-method approach, the study offers a rigorous and nuanced examination of the literature, ensuring a comprehensive understanding of the field and paving the way for future scholarly contributions.

This summarized work begins with an overview of the methodology for developing this review. The subsequent sections present the findings. Further future research directions are presented, followed by a discussion of the theoretical and managerial implications. Finally, the study's limitations are addressed, culminating in the conclusion.

TABLE 1 | Comparative analysis of systematic literature reviews on SMI research.

Author/year	Aim of the paper	SLR method	Critical synthesis/gaps
Vrontis et al. (2021)	To review SMI marketing and build an integrative framework	Thematic + TCCM	Focused on SMIs broadly within a marketing and advertising context. Limited attention to cross-cultural comparisons, platform-specific dynamics, and the role of video as a medium. Video content as a distinct persuasion mechanism was not examined.
Tanwar et al. (2022)	To review and bibliometrically analyse influencer marketing literature from 2011 to 2019	Bibliometric + Content Analysis	Mapped the evolution of influencer marketing research through performance and keyword analysis. Limited to pre-2020 literature, missing recent developments in video-driven influencer marketing. Content formats, particularly video, receive no systematic attention.
Fowler and Thomas (2023)	To map influencer marketing research and guide future work	Scoping Review (TCCM)	Examined SMIs from the perspective of 'human brands' within branding and consumer identity contexts. Highlighted the fragmented nature of the field but did not address video content as a distinct format or its unique psychological influence mechanisms.
Han and Balabanis (2024)	To meta-analyze antecedents and foundations of SMI impact	Meta-analysis	Centered on SMIs within the consumer psychology context, particularly credibility, trustworthiness, and expertise. Did not isolate video content as a variable and overlooked the role of audiovisual cues in shaping consumer behavior.
Aw and Agnihotri (2024)	To review influencer marketing effectiveness, ethics, and future directions	Narrative Literature Review	Examined influencer marketing through effectiveness, ethical considerations, and societal implications. Content format is not addressed as a variable. The role of video content in shaping consumer trust, attitudes, and purchase behavior remains entirely unaddressed.
Pushparaj and Kushwaha (2024)	To study SMIs' influence on consumer decisions	TCM + ADO Framework	Positioned SMIs within the consumer decision-making context and identified antecedents of influence. Highlighted gaps in cultural, contextual, and longitudinal studies but did not examine video as a distinct content format or its role as a persuasion mechanism.
Barari et al. (2025)	To meta-analyse the effectiveness of SMIs, including mechanisms and moderators	Meta-analysis	Examined SMI effectiveness through credibility and attractiveness across 71 papers. While moderators such as influencer size, platform, and product type are explored, video content is not treated as a distinct variable. The unique persuasive architecture of video remains absent from the analysis.

(Continues)

TABLE 1 | (Continued)

Author/year	Aim of the paper	SLR method	Critical synthesis/gaps
Beuckels and de Wolf (2025)	To systematically review parent influencer research and propose a future agenda	Thematic Analysis	Focused on parent influencers and their impact on parental identity and wellbeing. Scoped to a niche influencer segment. Video as a content format is not examined, leaving broader SMI video content dynamics and their psychological mechanisms unaddressed.
Joshi et al. (2025)	To map foundations and trends of SMI marketing through bibliometric-content analysis	Bibliometric + Content Analysis	Comprehensively mapped constructs such as parasocial relationships, authenticity, sponsorship, and engagement across 214 articles. Treats content as a broad category without isolating video as a distinct unit of analysis. The role of audiovisual storytelling and multimodal cues in shaping consumer behavior remains unaddressed.
Pan et al. (2025)	To assess influencer marketing effectiveness through antecedents, mediators, and moderators	Meta-analysis	Synthesized 1531 effect sizes examining post, follower, and influencer characteristics. Although post characteristics such as informational and hedonic value are considered, video as a specific content modality is not examined. How audiovisual elements uniquely activate cognitive and emotional consumer responses is not addressed.
Salunke et al. (2025)	To decode the effectiveness of SMI endorsements	SLR + 35 Interviews	Focused on SMIs in the endorsement and advertising context, offering a holistic endorsement framework. Remained limited to endorsement effectiveness and did not examine video content as a distinct persuasion medium or its psychological influence on consumer behavior.
Sardar and Vijay (2025)	To consolidate literature on SMIs and purchase intention and provide a research agenda	TCCM	Synthesized research on SMIs and purchase intention. Identified concentration in developed countries with limited psychological theorization and methodological diversity. Advances a broad agenda but does not address video content as a distinct format or its specific mechanisms in driving purchase intention.
Spörl-Wang et al. (2025)	To identify predictors of SMI marketing effectiveness	Review + Meta-analysis	Identified 56 predictors of SMI effectiveness across 93 articles. Focused on influencer and message characteristics broadly, without isolating video content as a predictor or moderator. The multimodal nature of video and its distinct psychological mechanisms remain unexplored.

(Continues)

TABLE 1 | (Continued)

Author/year	Aim of the paper	SLR method	Critical synthesis/gaps
This study	To examine the role of SMIs' video content on consumer behavior	TCCM + Topic Modeling + Interviews	Builds on prior SMI research but centers on video content as a unique persuasion mechanism. Methodologically advances the field by combining topic modeling and interviews. Identifies gaps in longitudinal video-based studies, cross-platform video comparisons (YouTube, TikTok, and Instagram), and the role of multimodal cues. Provides a taxonomy of variables to guide consumer behavior research in video environments.

Source: Author's elaboration.

2 | Research Methodology

The study adopts a framework-based review method using the TCCM framework and PRISMA protocol, complemented by a multi-method approach that integrates topic modeling (quantitative) and in-depth interviews (qualitative) to ensure rigor and comprehensiveness. The PRISMA (Preferred Reporting Items for Systematic Reviews and Meta-Analyses) protocol is applied by following seminal research (Liberati et al. 2009; Moher et al. 2015) and more recent guidelines (Ambika et al. 2025; Lim et al. 2022). The identification stage precedes the screening phase, which leads to eligibility checks and final article inclusion, as depicted in Figure 1.

2.1 | Search Protocol

Our literature review aligned with the approach described by Jain et al. (2024). We developed extensive keywords to search for literature on SMI-produced video content. The process began with a pilot search using the term “social media influencer” to identify foundational literature. The keywords used in the literature for describing social media influencers include “microcelebrity” (Khamis et al. 2017; Morais et al. 2022) alongside “digital influencer” (Torres et al. 2019; Uzunoğlu and Kip 2014) and “online celebrity” (Djafarova and Rushworth 2017). Our research included a comprehensive range of influencer terminology extending to digital, online, micro, macro, nano, and mega, as well as Insta influencers. We incorporated “influencer” as our keyword to gather available literature.

We also consulted academic and industry experts in social media influencer research to refine our keyword list. Based on iterative brainstorming and expert feedback, we finalized the keyword string as: (“Social media influencer” OR “influencer*” OR “digital influencer*” OR “micro celeb*” OR “online celeb*”). To narrow our study specifically to influencers' video content, we added the keyword “Video” with the AND notation. Therefore, the final keyword string for this study is “Social media influencer” OR “influencer” OR “digital influencers*” OR “micro celeb*” OR “online celeb*” AND Video. This string captures various terminologies while ensuring relevance to our focus on video-based influencer content. We searched for literature by evaluating the title, abstract, and keywords. This resulted in a total of 1000 articles.

2.2 | Inclusion Criteria

Based on the keywords reported in the previous section, we retrieved relevant literature from the Scopus database. The Scopus database is one of the largest databases hosting peer-reviewed research articles and provides extensive coverage of the indexed journals (Bhukya et al. 2022; Pandey and Tripathi 2025; Ray et al. 2026). Scopus includes more than 20,000 peer-reviewed journals published by prominent academic publishers such as Elsevier, Springer, Emerald, Taylor and Francis, Wiley, Informa, and Inderscience (Gupta et al. 2021). Compared to the Web of Science (WOS), Scopus offers better representativeness by covering more diversified subject areas and categories (Paul and Feliciano-Cestero 2021).

According to Vrontis and Christofi (2021), to ensure a broad and comprehensive overview, we did not restrict the study's time frame; instead, we included all relevant publications up to July 2025. Further, following Follmer and Jones (2018), we only considered the research articles published in the English language. Additionally, we narrowed down our review to the Business, Management, Accounting, Psychology, Decision Sciences, and Multidisciplinary fields to provide a specific focus for this research. Following the filtration discussed, we retrieved 243 relevant research articles.

2.3 | Exclusion Criteria

This section discusses the exclusion criterion for dropping specific, relatively unimportant articles. Referring to Paul and Feliciano-Cestero (2021), we applied the journal's quartile-based filter to assess the research's quality. We considered 151 and 47 (198 articles) high-quality research articles from the first and second quartiles, respectively. It ensures the objective assessment of the quality of the studies included in our review.

To further ensure that the selected research articles are within the domain of interest, we reviewed their abstracts and excluded those that did not align with our study, resulting in a final set of 112 research articles for detailed analysis. The articles were collaboratively screened by a domain expert to ensure alignment with the study's scope and objectives. During this process, we conducted brainstorming sessions to critically evaluate the

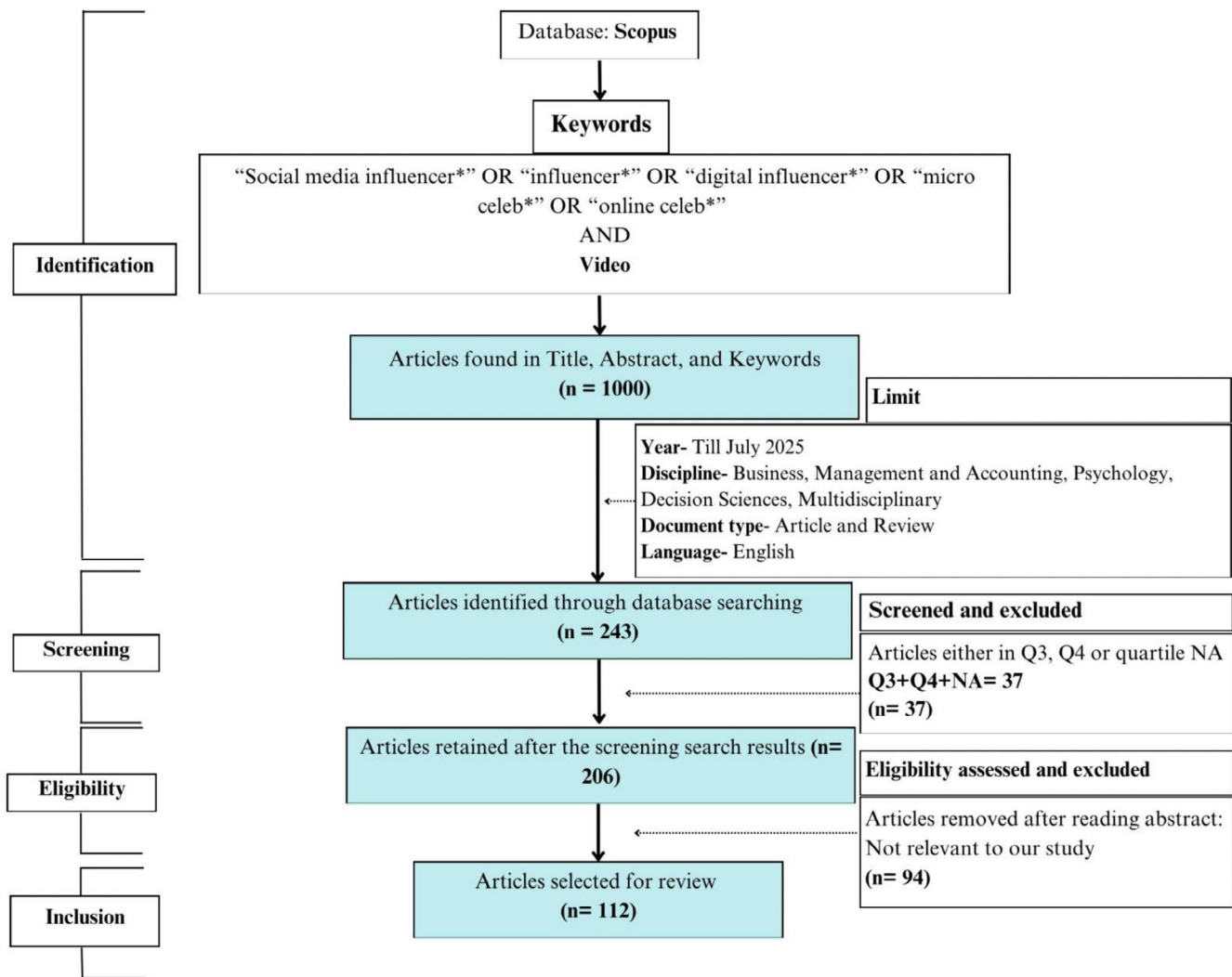


FIGURE 1 | Article selection process for the structured literature review (PRISMA Protocol, Moher et al. 2015).

relevance of each article by reviewing the titles and abstracts of the initially selected 206 papers. This refined selection formed the basis for our systematic review, guided by the PRISMA method (Figure 1).

3 | Findings

This section synthesizes the literature on SMIs' video content identified using the PRISMA method. The review begins with a descriptive analysis, followed by the TCCM framework. This study adopts a framework-based review method utilizing the TCCM (Theory, Context, Characteristics, Methodology) framework (Paul and Feliciano-Cestero 2021; Paul and Rosado-Serrano 2019). The approach enhances the comprehensiveness, rigor, and overall contribution of the study by providing a structured and systematic analysis of theoretical foundations, contextual settings, examined variables (dependent, independent, moderators, mediators), and methodological choices (Gupta et al. 2022; Paul and Feliciano-Cestero 2021; Paul and Rosado-Serrano 2019; Ford et al. 2023). To identify key themes within contextual settings, we employed a multi-method thematic analysis approach. Topic modeling using

the Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) method was applied to extract major themes from the literature quantitatively (Gaston-Breton and De Stefano 2025; Sağkaya Gungor et al. 2024), complemented by in-depth interviews with SMIs producing video content to add qualitative, real-world perspectives to the analysis (Salunke et al. 2025). The findings are presented within the TCCM framework, offering a structured foundation for future research development and bridging academic insights with industry practices.

3.1 | Descriptive Analysis

To address the first research question, 112 articles were analysed to identify publishing patterns, leading journals, and keyword co-occurrence networks within the literature.

3.1.1 | Publication Trend

Academic interest in SMIs' video content has grown substantially, reflecting the rapid evolution of digital marketing and consumer engagement strategies. In 2018–2019, only seven

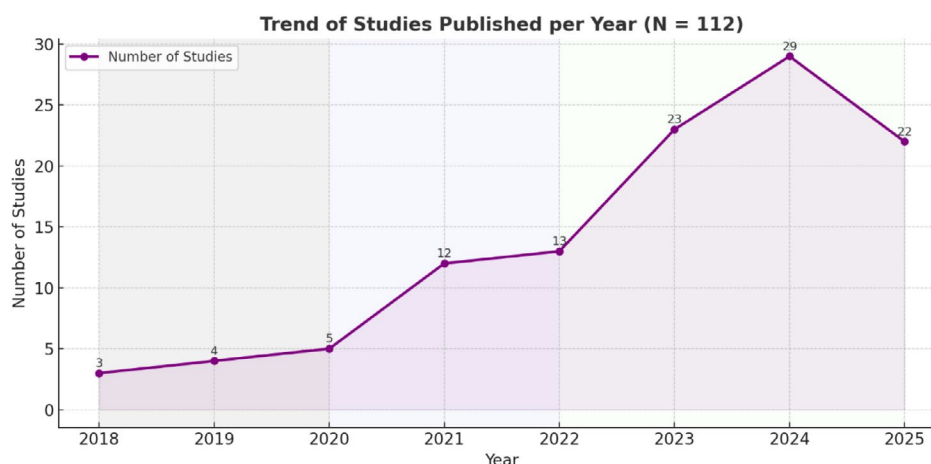


FIGURE 2 | Publication trend. *Source:* Author's elaboration.

studies were published (Figure 2), focusing on foundational themes such as credibility, advertising disclosures, and the persuasive impact of platforms like YouTube, emphasizing transparency and trust. By 2020–2021, output rose to 17 studies as research expanded into more diverse areas, including short-form videos, platform-specific features, and audience interaction mechanisms. This growth coincided with the COVID-19 pandemic, which accelerated digital adoption and intensified consumer reliance on online platforms. From 2022 onward, the field accelerated further, with 13 studies in 2022 and 23 in 2023, reflecting growing attention to authenticity, linguistic style, live streaming, and cross-platform engagement. Research peaked in 2024 with 29 studies, followed by 22 in 2025, underscoring the recognition of SMIs' video content as a central driver of consumer behavior, branding strategies, and emerging trends such as virtual SMI and AI-driven content analytics.

3.1.2 | Journal-Wise Classification

In this review article, a classification based on journals highlights the primary research sources on SMIs' video content. The 112 articles included in the review were published across 74 journals. Table 2 presents the top five contributing journals, with the *Journal of Advertising* (5) and the *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* (5) emerging as the most frequent publication outlets. Other notable journals include the *Journal of Interactive Advertising* (4) and the *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing* (4). Several journals contributed three or fewer articles each, while the majority of journals in the dataset published only one article. Overall, the publication of research on SMIs' video content is anchored largely in marketing and advertising journals. However, it is also gaining attention in fields such as psychology, information systems, and tourism. This interdisciplinary spread reflects the evolving and expanding nature of the field. While marketing journals continue to dominate the discourse, contributions from other domains create opportunities for new theoretical insights and richer methodological approaches to advance SMI's video research.

TABLE 2 | Journal-wise classification.

Sources	Articles
<i>Journal of Advertising</i>	5
<i>Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services</i>	5
<i>Journal of Business Research</i>	4
<i>Journal of Interactive Advertising</i>	4
<i>Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing</i>	4

Source: Author's elaboration.

3.1.3 | Keyword co-Occurrence Analysis

To identify conceptual relationships within the SMIs video content literature, a keyword co-occurrence analysis was conducted using VOSviewer software (Figure 3). Co-occurrence analysis examines how frequently keywords appear together within documents, revealing semantic relationships and research patterns (Van Eck and Waltman 2010). The network revealed three main clusters. The first (red) cluster centers on marketing and commercial themes, with keywords such as social media, influencers, marketing, and commerce, indicating a strong focus on business and economic outcomes. The second (green) cluster reflects content creation and human elements, linking TikTok, advertising, videorecording, male, female, and persuasion knowledge, highlighting research on creator characteristics, platform strategies, and audience processing of influencer content. The third (blue) cluster emphasizes digital platforms and audience targeting, connecting influencer marketing, YouTube, children, and internet, suggesting attention to platform-specific strategies and ethical concerns, particularly regarding younger audiences. Overall, the interconnections between clusters reveal the multidisciplinary nature of SMIs video content research, with SMIs serving as central bridging concepts that connect marketing, content creation, and audience targeting strategies, indicating that the field has evolved beyond simple commercial applications to encompass broader questions of digital culture and audience engagement.

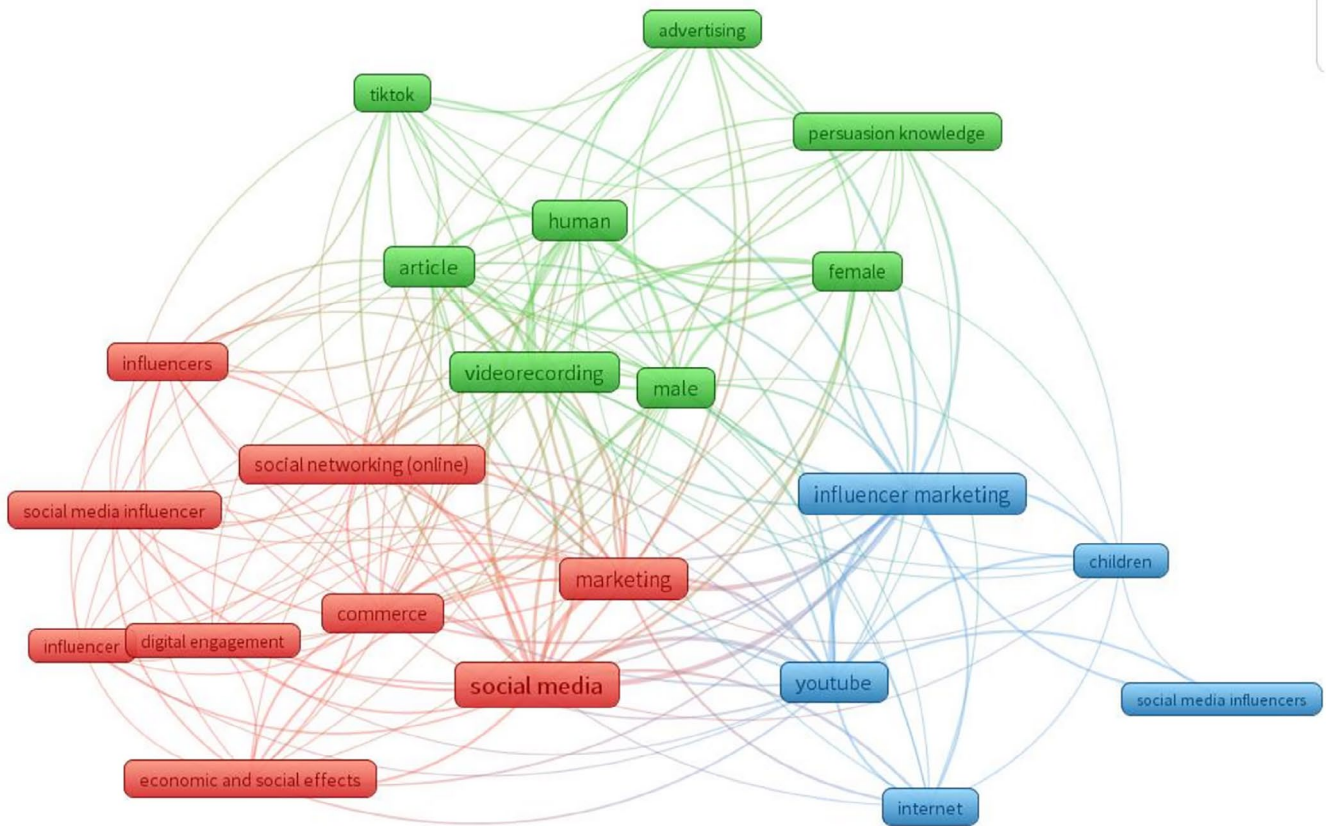


FIGURE 3 | Co-occurrence network. Source: VOSviewer.

3.2 | The Theories, Contexts, Characteristics, and Methods (TCCM) Framework

For the framework-based review, we adopted the TCCM framework to ensure rigor, relevance, and impact, as it provides a comprehensive structure for organizing literature across theories (T), contexts (C), characteristics (C), and methods (M) (Paul and Feliciano-Cestero 2021; Paul and Rosado-Serrano 2019; Sharma and Kushwah 2025). The selection of TCCM derives from its ability to integrate theoretical dimensions with empirical components, thereby offering a deeper understanding of the subject and enhancing replicability through a transparent process for study selection, coding, and analysis (Paul and Feliciano-Cestero 2021; Paul et al. 2024). Importantly, this framework supports cumulative knowledge development by identifying gaps, refining conceptual frameworks, and consolidating fragmented insights (Paul and Criado 2020).

While alternative frameworks such as ADO and TCM make valuable contributions to systematic literature reviews, they serve distinct analytical purposes. ADO excels at mapping antecedents, decisions, and outcomes, providing clarity about construct-level relationships. TCM provides strength in examining contextual factors that shape findings. Their combined use broadens analytical scope but can also increase complexity. TCCM, by comparison, synthesizes the strengths of both by systematically incorporating theoretical, contextual, characteristic, and methodological dimensions. This integrated

approach is particularly suitable for our study, as SMIs' video content research is inherently multifaceted, requiring attention to theoretical foundations, platform contexts, content characteristics, and methodological approaches that shape consumer behavior outcomes (Chen et al. 2021; Sharma et al. 2020).

The TCCM framework captures the theories, contexts, characteristics, and methodologies applied within the SMIs video literature (Paul and Feliciano-Cestero 2021) as shown in Figure 4. It identifies the theoretical foundations to showcase the diverse conceptual perspectives adopted in previous studies and to guide future research directions. Contexts are mapped to highlight the various themes and situational settings examined in the literature (Jain et al. 2024). The characteristics systematically outline the key variables investigated: dependent, independent, moderator, and mediator. Lastly, the methodological dimension discusses the analytical techniques, sampling strategies, and data sources utilized in SMIs video-related studies.

3.2.1 | Theories (T)

Establishing a strong theoretical foundation is essential for advancing research and developing the academic domain (Hunt 2018). In the context of SMIs' video content, the literature is underpinned by a diverse and evolving set of theoretical frameworks. The 84 out of 112 reviewed articles draw upon 45 distinct theories, demonstrating considerable theoretical variety and

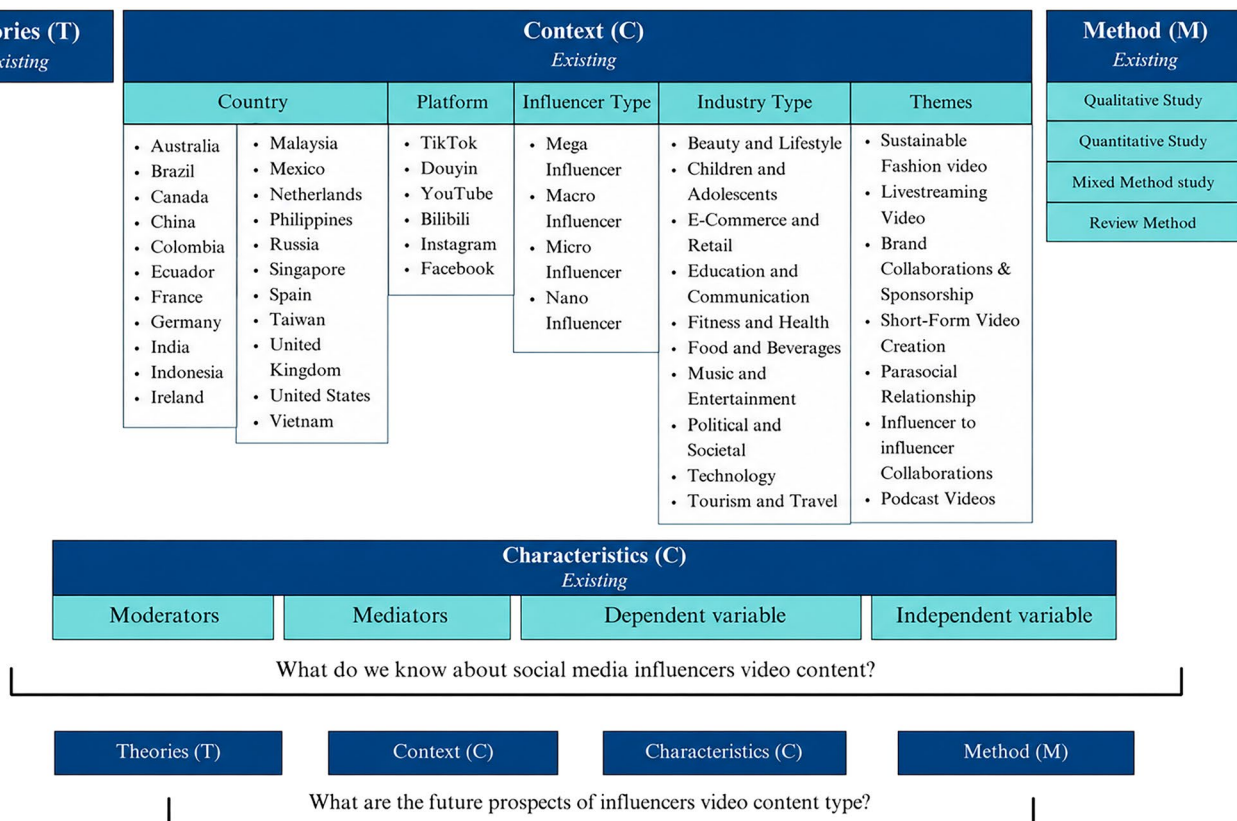


FIGURE 4 | TCCM framework application. *Source:* Adopted from Paul and Feliciano-Cestero (2021), Paul and Rosado-Serrano (2019), Lim, Donkers, et al. (2021) and Lim, Yap, and Makkar (2021).

breadth within this domain. Among the most frequently applied frameworks are the Persuasion Knowledge Model (PKM), Parasocial Relationship Theory, and Source Credibility Theory, each cited in seven studies (Table 3). These theories underscore the central role of persuasion awareness, emotional connections, and perceptions of trustworthiness and expertise in explaining how SMIs' videos influence consumer responses. The Stimulus–Organism–Response (SOR) Model, examined in six studies, highlights how external video stimuli translate into internal consumer states and subsequent behaviors. Additionally, Signaling Theory, integrated in four studies, emphasizes how SMIs communicate cues of quality, credibility, and authenticity that guide audience interpretation and engagement.

The literature reflects an evolving interdisciplinary foundation, integrating theories from Communication and Media, Psychology, Marketing and Consumer Behavior, Sociology, and Information Systems (Refer to Appendix S1). The primary focus, however, is on theories from Psychology and Communication and Media, which dominate the research due to their relevance in understanding how consumers engage with and respond to SMIs' videos. This dominance is evident in the rise of theoretical diversity over time, as illustrated in Figures 5 and 6. There has been a sharp increase in theoretical variety post-2020, with notable peaks in Psychology theories in 2024 and sustained application across multiple disciplines (Figure 6). This overall shift in theoretical focus underscores the need for a multidomain approach that acknowledges the intersection of persuasive communication,

emotional engagement, consumer behavior, and technology-driven interaction.

3.2.2 | Context (C)

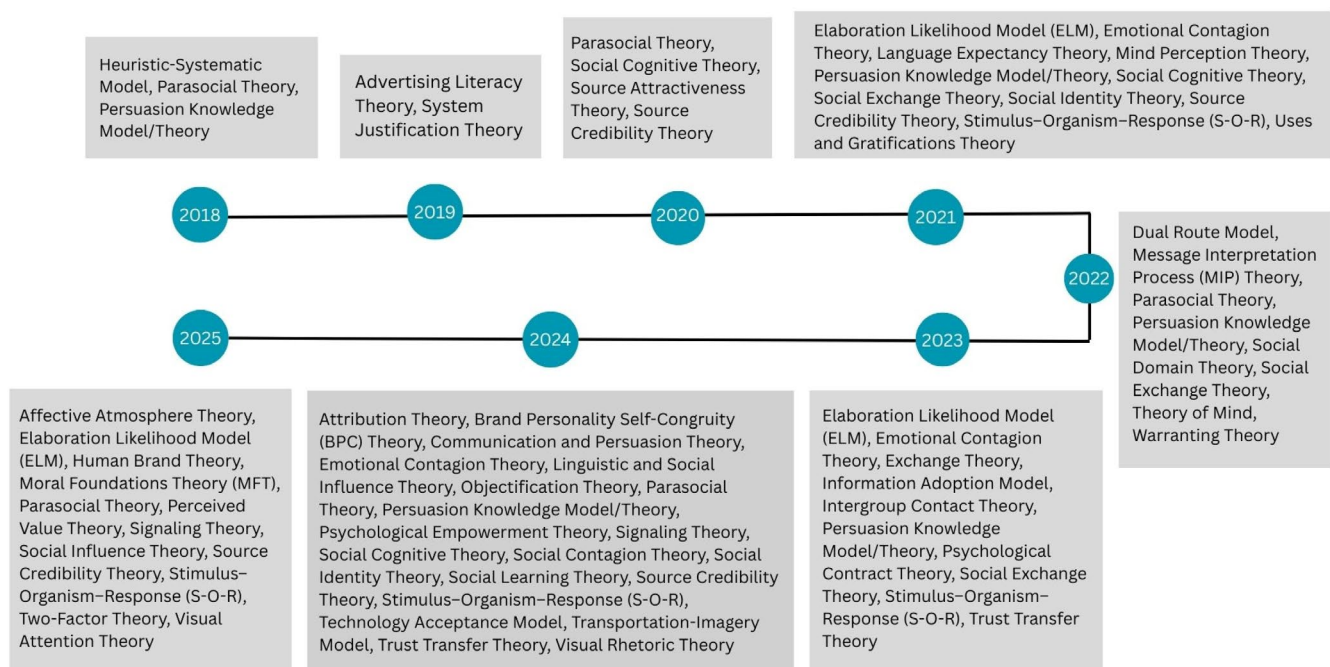
In the context section, we synthesized the literature on SMIs' video content across social media platforms, countries, industries, and the different types of SMIs. Additionally, we identified key emerging and established themes by integrating insights from topic modelling and in-depth interviews.

Examining the social media platform landscape, the literature on SMIs' video content predominantly focuses on YouTube and TikTok. YouTube, accounting for 47% of the studies, has garnered the most attention due to its diverse video formats and large user base, making it a central platform for SMIs (Boerman et al. 2024; Chen, Nguyen, et al. 2024; Chen, Chen, and Pan 2024). TikTok, representing 30% of the studies, has been extensively studied for its rapid growth and substantial impact on younger demographics through short-form viral content (Tham et al. 2024; Tian et al. 2024). Platforms like Instagram (5%) and Facebook (4%) have received moderate research attention. Meanwhile, Douyin (6%) and Bilibili (7%) stand out for their unique cultural significance in China (Chen, Nguyen, et al. 2024; Chen, Chen, and Pan 2024). Overall, this indicates that although YouTube and TikTok dominate SMIs' video research, emerging platforms like Instagram Reels and Douyin are reshaping the landscape and highlight the need for greater cross-platform comparative studies.

TABLE 3 | List of theories.

Theory	Key studies	Frequency
Persuasion knowledge model (PKM)	Bargoni et al. (2024); Castonguay (2022); Castonguay (2022); Evans et al. (2018); Gong and Holiday (2023); Kim et al. (2021); Kim and Kim (2022); Liao and Chen (2024)	7
Parasocial relationships	De Jans et al. (2018); Dam et al. (2024); Yoo et al. (2024); Wang et al. (2025); van Reijmersdal and van Dam (2020); Zhou et al. (2024); Thelwall et al. (2022)	7
Source credibility theory	Li and Sun (2024); Chen et al. (2025); Rizomyliotis et al. (2024); Saima and Khan (2020); Lee and Theokary (2021); Coates et al. (2020); Fong et al. (2025)	7
Stimuli-organism-response (SOR) theory	Lu et al. (2024); Yin et al. (2024); Lee and Wan (2023); García-de-Frutos and Estrella-Ramón (2021); Barta et al. (2023); Li, Wang, et al. (2025); Li, Kim, et al. (2025)	6
Signaling theory	Zhang et al. (2024); Cheng and Zhang (2025); Li, Wang, et al. (2025); Li, Kim, et al. (2025); Zhang and Tian (2025)	4

Source: Author's elaboration.

**FIGURE 5** | Evolution of theory over time. Source: Author's elaboration.

Within geographic contexts, existing studies on SMIs' video content reveal a diverse distribution across countries with notable regional differences (Table 4). This study shows that China dominates as the most investigated country with 29% of studies, concentrating on SMIs videos on platforms like TikTok that impact consumer behavior. The United States follows, with 15% of studies focusing primarily on YouTube and Instagram and investigating these platforms' psychological and behavioral effects. The Netherlands contributes 5% of studies, mostly examining advertising literacy focused on youth, especially adolescents. The United Kingdom accounts for 4% of studies

exploring credibility and authenticity in SMIs' video content, while Spain contributes 3% of studies. However, this geographic concentration reveals a critical research gap as emerging markets remain significantly underrepresented. India, Indonesia, Brazil, and other developing nations collectively contribute less than 10% despite having rapidly expanding digital populations and growing influencer economies. This imbalance limits the global applicability of current findings and highlights the urgent need for cross-cultural research to understand how SMI video content effectiveness varies across diverse cultural, economic, and technological contexts worldwide.

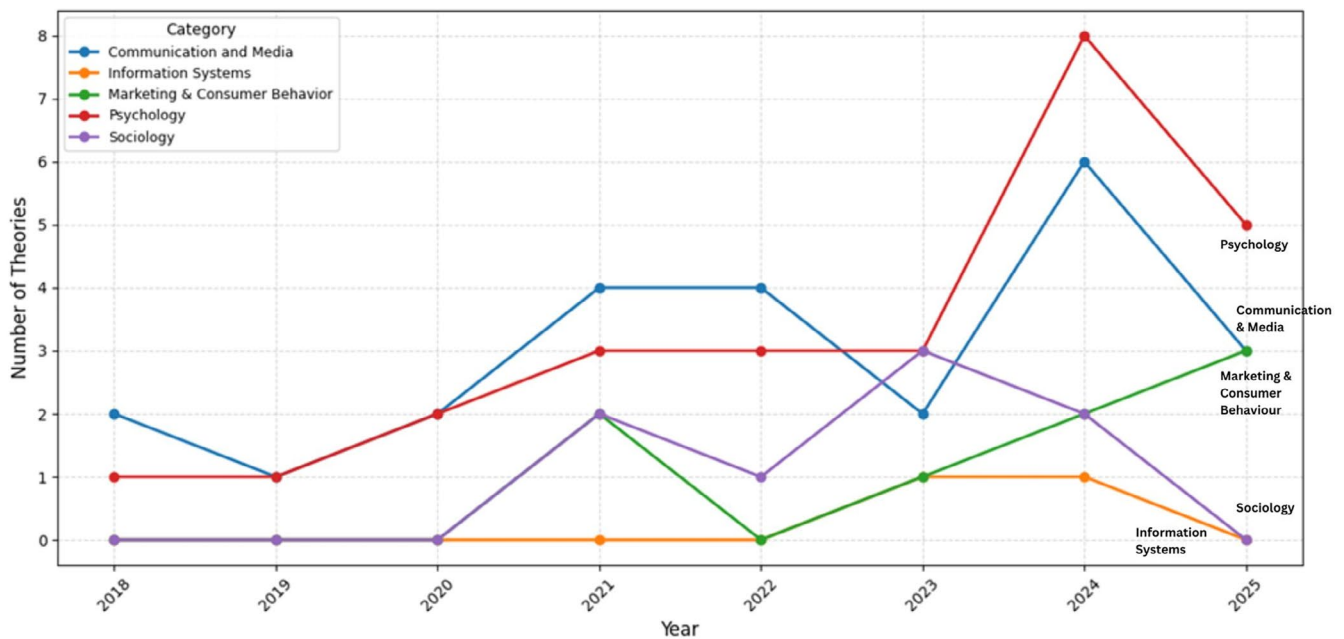


FIGURE 6 | Number of theories per domain over the years. *Source:* Author's elaboration.

TABLE 4 | List of countries.

Country/Region	No. of Studies	Sample Studies
China	32	(Chan et al. 2023; Chen, Nguyen, et al. 2024; Wen et al. 2025)
United States	17	(Anderson et al. 2025; Kim et al. 2021; Stubb et al. 2019)
Netherlands	6	(Boerman and van Reijmersdal 2020; Van der Bend et al. 2023)
United Kingdom	4	(Coates et al. 2020; Thelwall et al. 2022)

Source: Author's elaboration.

Furthermore, from an industry perspective, the literature highlights the growing relevance of SMIs' video content, with most attention given to tourism, food and beverages, and beauty and lifestyle (Table 5). In tourism, SMIs promote destinations and shape consumer preferences through immersive travel experiences (Villamediana-Pedrosa et al. 2019; Qiu et al. 2024). Food and beverages research shows their impact on consumer choices and sustainability (Boerman and van Reijmersdal 2020; Zhong et al. 2023), while beauty and lifestyle studies emphasize trend formation, aesthetic aspirations, and personal branding (Anderson et al. 2025). Beyond these industries, SMIs also play a role in e-commerce through live-streaming and loyalty-building (Ge et al. 2021; Gu et al. 2024), and in entertainment by driving audience engagement (Barta et al. 2023; Jiang et al. 2024). Additional

studies note their influence in fitness and health (Sokolova and Perez 2021; Yin et al. 2024), youth-related ethical concerns (Castonguay 2022), education (Xiao et al. 2018), politics (Zimmermann et al. 2022; Zhao and Zhang 2024), and technology, particularly blockchain and Web3 (Broadbridge et al. 2023; Meyer et al. 2023). Overall, tourism, e-commerce, and beauty dominate current research, while areas such as technology, education, and adolescents remain underexplored despite their growing importance in shaping online learning, consumption, and decision-making.

Moreover, examining the diversity of SMI types, the existing literature identifies various types of SMIs categorized based on follower size into nano (1–10K), micro (10–100K), macro (100K–1M), and mega/celebrity (over 1M). Studies demonstrate that macro-influencers play a central role in shaping digital engagement and consumer value (Liao and Chen 2024; Lu et al. 2024; Wen et al. 2025). Comparative analyses highlight distinct strategies of micro- versus macro-influencers in driving likes, shares, and emotional engagement across platforms such as TikTok and YouTube (Chan et al. 2023; Hung et al. 2022; Yoo et al. 2024). Mega- and celebrity influencers dominate video contexts such as livestreaming on tourism and health communication, as their large reach ensures visibility but sometimes reduces authenticity (Gu et al. 2024; Li and Sun 2024; Motta et al. 2024; Zhao and Zhang 2024). Conversely, nano-influencers, though less studied, are shown to foster authenticity and strong parasocial connections that enhance engagement in video content (Gong and Holiday 2023; Munaro et al. 2024). This classification contributes significantly in understanding how SMIs tier affects video content effectiveness, revealing a critical paradox: while larger SMIs achieve greater reach, smaller SMIs often generate deeper emotional connections, suggesting that optimal video marketing strategies could balance scale with authenticity rather than simply prioritizing follower count.

TABLE 5 | Industry-focused in SMIs videos research.

Industry focus	No. of studies	Sample studies
Beauty and Lifestyle	10	García-de-Frutos and Estrella-Ramón (2021); Wen et al. (2025); Anderson et al. (2025)
Children and Adolescents	5	Castonguay (2022); De Jans et al. (2018)
E-Commerce and Retail	17	Ge et al. (2021); Liao and Chen (2024); Yuan et al. (2025)
Education and Communication	5	Xiao et al. (2018); Chen, Nguyen, et al. (2024)
Fitness and Health	6	Sokolova and Perez (2021); Motta et al. (2024); Pryde et al. (2024)
Food and Beverages	6	Boerman and van Reijmersdal (2020); Zhong et al. (2023)
Music and Entertainment	6	Barta et al. (2023); Munaro et al. (2024)
Political and Societal	6	Zimmermann et al. (2022); Andreeva et al. (2025)
Technology	5	Broadbridge et al. (2023); Agrawal and Mittal (2025)
Tourism and Travel	19	Villamediana-Pedrosa et al. (2019); Yoo et al. (2024); Wu and Lai (2025)

Source: Author's elaboration.

Building on this contextual synthesis of platforms, countries, industries, and SMIs types, we next move to a thematic analysis to uncover deeper patterns in SMIs' video content.

3.2.2.1 | Themes. For thematic analysis within the domain of SMIs video content, we integrated a quantitative (Topic modeling) approach with a qualitative approach (In-depth interviews). This integration effectively bridges the gap between scholarly discourse and real-world application. Following prior studies, themes are extracted using topic modeling techniques applied to the abstracts of the research papers identified for this study (Gaston-Breton and De Stefano 2025; Sağkaya Gungor et al. 2024). Additionally, interviews are conducted with SMIs, considered domain experts, to further identify and enrich themes (Salunke et al. 2025).

Integrating topic modeling with in-depth interviews enables methodological triangulation, thereby enhancing the credibility, depth, and validity of the identified themes. This multi-method approach helps to minimize potential biases that arise from relying solely on either textual analysis or subjective expert opinion. Topic modeling offers a broad, data-driven overview of dominant and latent themes within the existing academic literature (Yong et al. 2024), while interviews with SMIs considered domain experts add contextual depth and practical relevance (Salunke et al. 2025). Interestingly, we identified an emerging theme from the interviews that was not extensively discussed in the literature, which holds potential for future research directions. By comparing and aligning the computationally derived topics with insights gathered from practitioners actively engaged in the field, we ensure that the identified themes are theoretically grounded and practically relevant.

3.2.2.1.1 | Topic Modelling. For thematic analysis within the domain of SMIs' video content, we employed topic modeling as a computational method to identify latent themes from the academic literature. Using Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA), a widely applied technique in systematic literature reviews (Evangelopoulos 2015; Sağkaya Gungor et al. 2024;

Mohammadi and Karami 2022), we analysed the abstracts of 112 research articles. The texts were preprocessed in Python through punctuation removal, stopword elimination, and lemmatization. LDA, a generative probabilistic model, assumes that documents are mixtures of topics and that each topic is represented by a probability distribution over keywords (Blei et al. 2003). Since LDA models words probabilistically, a single keyword could appear across multiple topics when occurring in varied contexts. Following standard practices, we identified five topics that offered optimal thematic coverage while maintaining interpretability (Table 6). Each topic was characterized by its most probable words, and we examined representative documents with the strongest loadings to interpret and label them. To label each theme, we conducted discussions with academic experts and brainstorming sessions using identified keywords to assign themes to each topic, thereby ensuring coherence and interpretive rigor.

3.2.2.1.2 | In-Depth Interviews. We adopted an evidence-based approach using in-depth interviews using a purposive sampling method (Salunke et al. 2025), as this method is particularly effective for capturing personal narratives and generating detailed insights into professional practices. To ensure diverse perspectives, 50 SMIs were approached via email and different social media platforms. While many did not respond, 15 initially agreed to participate, and additional participants were recruited through snowball sampling, resulting in 28 completed interviews, each labelled from E01 to E28 (see Appendix S3 for participant demographics). Each interview was conducted in English, lasted between 40 and 70 min, and was recorded with the participants' consent (using the semi-structured interview guide detailed in Appendix S2). By the 25th interview, recurring patterns began to emerge, and three further interviews were conducted to achieve theoretical saturation (Hennink and Kaiser 2022; Salunke et al. 2025). In line with the guidelines of Zeithaml et al. (2020), the interview data were transcribed immediately after each session, and the interview guide was iteratively refined to capture emerging insights and potential research gaps. Confidentiality was strictly maintained, and pseudonyms were used to ensure anonymity.

TABLE 6 | Topics identified using topic modelling.

Topics	Keywords	Expert-assigned labels
Topic 1	Fashion, item, face, comment, emotional, sustainable, multimodal, route, narrative	Sustainable fashion
Topic 2	ASMR, service, streamer, internet, loyalty, livestreaming, satisfaction	Livestream video creation
Topic 3	Video, influencers, disclosure, advertising, marketing, engagement, product, medium, content, brand	Brand Collaborations & disclosure
Topic 4	Influencers, short, video, marketing, linguistic, medium, internet, celebrity, emotional	Short-Form Video Creation
Topic 5	PSI, SMI, small, strong, productivity, seeking, foreign, Parasocial	Parasocial Relationship

Source: Author's elaboration.

The interview data were analyzed using reflexive thematic analysis (Braun and Clarke 2006). The process followed several steps: familiarization through transcription and repeated readings; systematic coding of significant features across the dataset; collating codes into broader categories and potential themes; reviewing and refining themes for coherence; and clearly defining and naming the final themes (Figure 7). To ensure reliability, two coders independently reviewed and refined the theme definitions and labels, with discrepancies resolved through discussion until consensus was reached. Domain experts in consumer behavior and influencer marketing participated in brainstorming sessions to refine themes and ensure academic-practitioner alignment. Representative participant quotes were then selected to illustrate key insights (comprehensive thematic results are presented in Appendix S4, with expert mapping provided in Appendix S5), and the themes were linked to the study objectives to produce a coherent framework that reflects SMIs' video content practices, audience engagement strategies, and professional experiences.

3.2.2.1.3 | Themes Identified Through Methodological Triangulation. This study employed methodological triangulation, integrating computational topic modeling with qualitative in-depth interviews to systematically examine the convergence between academic literature and practitioners' experiences in SMIs' video content creation. The analysis of 112 research article abstracts using Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) algorithms, complemented by interviews with 28 SMIs, revealed five established themes (Appendix S6) where theoretical frameworks align with industry practices and two emerging themes (Appendix S6) that represent significant gaps in current academic discourse, as shown in Figure 7. These findings not only validate existing scholarly perspectives but also extend the knowledge frontier by incorporating practitioner-driven insights, thereby emphasising the need for future research to bridge the theory–practice divide in SMIs' video content studies.

Established Themes: The study identified five established themes, as shown in Figure 7, that are consistently reinforced by both Topic Modelling and In-depth Interview, reflecting well-grounded areas in SMIs' video content research.

The first established theme centers on sustainable fashion, where sustainability consistently emerges in SMIs' video literature as a driver of authenticity and trust, with eco-conscious

storytelling shown to encourage ethical consumption (Haines et al. 2023; Kim et al. 2021; Li, Wang, et al. 2025; Li, Kim, et al. 2025). Interviews acknowledged this but uncovered practical struggles and contradictions. E02 stated, “I restyle old clothes to keep content fresh without overbuying”, while E04 emphasized, “Upcycling is both content and message”. Yet, challenges were also evident. E22 admitted, “I face pressure from fast fashion sponsors”, and E23 added, “Many brands aren't available locally”. Critically, while the literature often idealizes sustainability as a trust signal, SMIs revealed slower audience growth: “eco-content grows slower, but followers are loyal” (E02) and persistent misconceptions such as “people think sustainable is equal to expensive” (E22). This shows a disjuncture: sustainable fashion builds deep loyalty but is harder to scale, exposing a tension between ethical intent and market constraints.

Another significant theme that emerged is livestreaming video creation, which the literature frames as a tool for creating immersive experiences and building loyalty through real-time interaction and service cues (Chen, Nguyen, et al. 2024; Chen, Chen, and Pan 2024; Zhang et al. 2024). Interviews enriched this by highlighting the technical and performative details that sustain engagement. E06 emphasized, “Good lighting makes me look professional,” while E04 stated, “In my livestreaming audio quality matters more than video sometimes.” Timing also emerged as crucial, with E14 noting, “I go live when my analytics say most followers are online.” Interactive dynamics were enhanced through personalization. E08 stated, “I call out usernames to make it personal,” and E02 observed, “Live chat creates instant community feeling.” This suggests that beyond the immersive qualities highlighted in literature, SMIs rely on micro-level technical setups and timing strategies. Critically, livestream success is not just about relational bonds but about operational mastery, which current scholarship tends to underplay.

The third theme focuses on brand collaborations and disclosure, which has been studied within academic studies, conceptualising disclosures as a way of shaping persuasion, knowledge, and showing that seamless integration of sponsorships can strengthen credibility (Boerman and van Reijmersdal 2020; Johnson et al. 2022). Interviews revealed that SMIs are not only transparent out of compliance but have repositioned disclosure as a trust-building strategy. E11 reflected, “Earlier, I used to skip brand names casually, but now I openly mention partnerships because audiences value

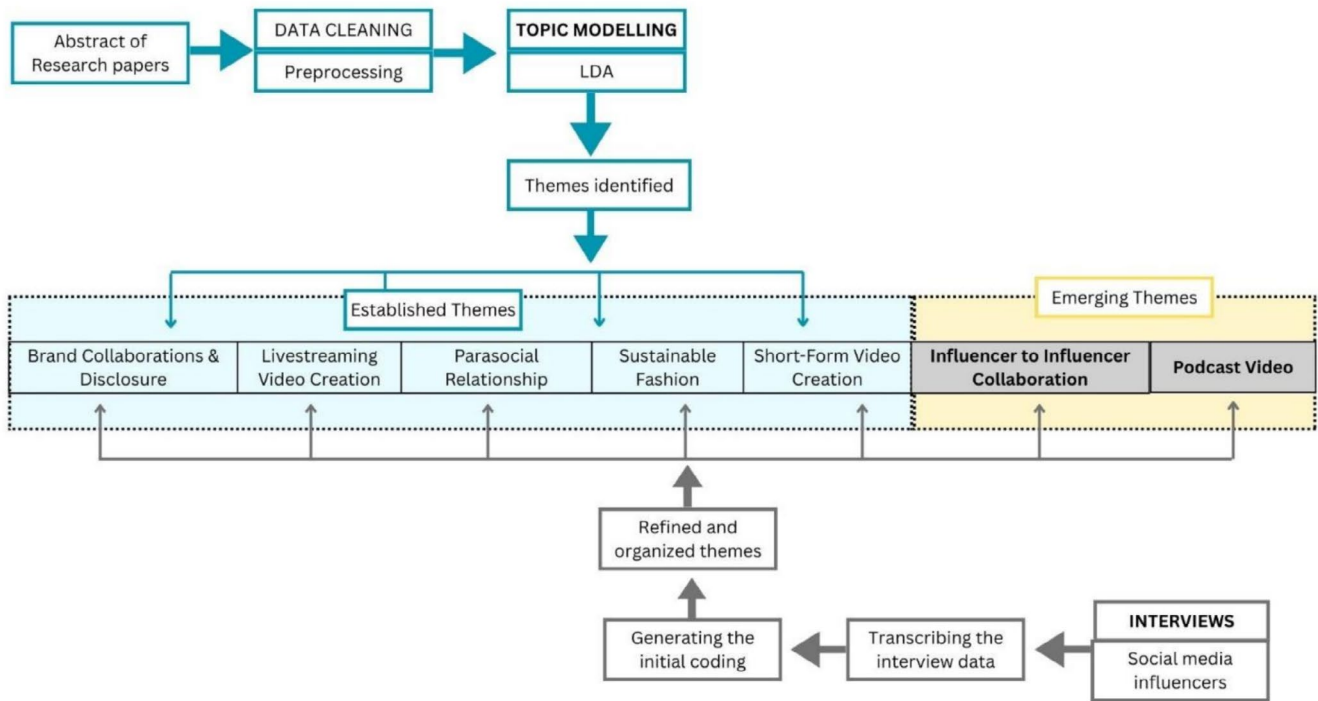


FIGURE 7 | Integrated framework for thematic analysis. *Source:* Author's elaboration.

honesty,” while E12 stated, “I always say ‘this is sponsored’—hiding it backfires.” Moreover, SMIs strategically integrate brand values into their narratives, as E18 described, “I now share why I chose this brand in my captions as it adds transparency and helps engagement.” Critically, while literature views disclosure as a neutral compliance mechanism, interviews reveal it as an asset and differentiator. Transparency thus evolves from obligation to competitive advantage, reframing how credibility is managed in influencer-brand collaborations.

The fourth established theme examines short-form video creation, which highlights that its virality depends on linguistic triggers, emotional language, and compressed storytelling structures (Matiza and Slabbert 2024; Yang, Han, et al. 2025; Yang, Wang, et al. 2025). Interviews enriched these dynamics but added more applied insights. E13 stated, “The first three seconds decide everything,” while E16 elaborated, “Hook, build tension, then deliver, it works every time.” Language and audio were equally important: E11 shared, “Adding trending audio makes content instantly clickable,” and E09 noted, “Emotional words like ‘shocking’ or ‘life-changing’ grab attention.” Importantly, E10 observed, “Authentic moments often outperform planned content.” This illustrates a paradox: while algorithms reward optimized storytelling, audiences often reward unpolished authenticity. Thus, although the literature highlights linguistic/emotional strategies, interviews reveal that virality emerges at the intersection of deliberate tactics and serendipitous relatability.

The fifth theme addresses parasocial relationships, which highlight how SMIs create emotionally engaging, one-sided interactions that feel personal and authentic to audiences. Studies further demonstrate that parasocial bonds, combined with cultural adaptation, help foster trust and a sense of belonging (Jiang et al. 2024; Yoo et al. 2024). Interviews revealed

that the behind-the-scenes SMIs invest in sustaining these relationships. E08 stated, “I show parts of my daily life so people feel I’m like them, not just a face on screen,” while E19 added, “I reply to as many DMs as possible—it shows I care.” Trust also emerged as a boundary marker: E14 stressed, “I only recommend products I’ve used personally, otherwise it feels dishonest,” and E09 admitted, “The audience trusts me, so I can’t betray them.” Critically, while literature emphasizes audience perception, interviews reveal the self-regulation practices of SMIs to maintain integrity. Parasocial bonds, therefore, are co-constructed through both audience attachment and SMIs’ responsibility.

Emerging Themes: Alongside the established themes, the in-depth interviews revealed two emerging themes, as shown in Figure 7, that remain underexplored in the literature. The practitioner-driven insights open new avenues for future research on SMIs’ video content.

Podcast video content emerges as an interesting theme, with interviews highlighting its potential to establish SMIs’ authority and foster deeper audience relationships through extended storytelling. Unlike short-form formats, podcasts enable long-form engagement that builds credibility and sustained viewer connection. The analysis highlights three transformative elements. Multi-modal production blends audio and visuals, as noted by E17: “I record my podcast with multiple cameras knowing I’ll create video versions. The visual element completely changes engagement,” while E20 stressed, “Audio quality is still king, but pairing it with compelling visuals creates this perfect storm.” Platform optimization relies on content repurposing, with E19 explaining, “YouTube gets the full episode, Instagram gets key moments with the most viral clips.” Finally, long-form engagement is measured through richer qualitative metrics. E18 observed, “A podcast video with fewer views

but higher watch time completion tells me the content truly resonated,” while E22 tracks “visual retention heatmaps to see exactly where people’s attention drops.” Together, these strategies show how podcasts move beyond traditional audio to deliver sustained, multi-platform engagement.

Influencer-to-influencer collaboration is another emerging theme, representing sophisticated peer partnership ecosystems grounded in value alignment and strategic audience expansion. Practitioners demonstrate mutual benefit structures: “Collaborating with other influencers helps us to share our followers and create authentic video” (E22) while maintaining selective partnership criteria: “Sometimes I say no to another influencer to work with if their content doesn’t fit my eco-aesthetic” (E22). The credibility amplification mechanism operates through dual endorsement effects: “When two creators genuinely believe in a product and come together to talk about it, it just hits differently... It’s like getting a recommendation from two friends you really trust, not just a simple ad” (E18). This collaborative framework represents a fundamental shift from individual influence models toward networked credibility systems where trust transfers laterally between influencers before reaching audiences, challenging existing theoretical frameworks that focus primarily on direct influencer-consumer relationships.

3.2.3 | Characteristics (C)

This section discusses the major dependent, independent, moderating, and mediating variables and the tested relationships to explain the phenomenon. Figure 8 presents the Integrated Framework for Characteristics.

3.2.3.1 | Independent Variable. The literature on SMIs’ video content reveals 117 distinct independent variables. These variables are organized into seven main categories that demonstrate the field’s growth and maturity. Video content features establish the technical foundation of influence, focusing on visual and audio elements and storytelling components that determine message effectiveness (Wang et al. 2025; Li, Wang, et al. 2025). SMIs’ characteristics capture personal dimensions of influence, including authenticity, charisma, leadership qualities, and credibility factors such as trustworthiness, expertise, and attractiveness (Liao and Chen 2024; Munaro et al. 2024; Wen et al. 2025). Emotional and psychological factors explain influence mechanisms, examining emotions such as anger, disgust, fear, and joy to understand their impact on consumer behavior (Yoo et al. 2024). Sponsorship disclosure elements address regulatory and ethical dimensions, focusing on disclosure timing and transparency to ensure compliance and maintain trust (Castonguay 2022). Contextual and platform-specific factors recognize environmental conditions affecting content performance. Brand integration variables assess alignment between SMIs and products, while demographic factors account for audience characteristics influencing message reception (Kim and Choo 2023; Motta et al. 2024). The distinct independent variables contribute to the literature by demonstrating how SMIs’ video research has evolved from simple trust-based studies to comprehensive analyses that integrate technical production, psychological processes, regulatory requirements, and situational factors,

providing a theoretical foundation for understanding how video content creation strategies and consumer behavior interact in digital influence ecosystems.

3.2.3.2 | Moderator. A moderator influences the strength or direction of the relationship between an independent and dependent variable (Baron and Kenny 1986). The literature identifies 38 moderators across 112 studies, showing that SMIs’ effectiveness depends on multiple boundary conditions. Factors such as product integration, campaign characteristics, and sponsored labels affect how promotional content resonates (Gu et al. 2024; Yang, Han, et al. 2025; Yang, Wang, et al. 2025). SMIs’ attributes such as competence, brand fit, and follower count also alter influence strength (Liao and Chen 2024; Wen et al. 2025; Wang et al. 2025). Audience responses are shaped by cultural settings and price cues (Aquino and Cabalquinto 2025; Yuan et al. 2025), as well as community validation and parasocial interaction (Anderson et al. 2025). Platform-specific features such as audiovisual congruence and real-time interaction further affect effectiveness (Yang, Han, et al. 2025; Yang, Wang, et al. 2025; Zhang and Tian 2025). Overall, these moderators shows that SMIs’ influence is conditional on content design, SMIs traits, audience characteristics, context, and platform affordances.

3.2.3.3 | Mediator. Mediator variables explain how independent variables influence outcomes by revealing underlying psychological and social mechanisms (Jain et al. 2023). The literature identifies 40 mediators across 112 studies. Parasocial relationships and online social well-being shape engagement (Chen, Nguyen, et al. 2024; Chen, Chen, and Pan 2024; Motta et al. 2024), while brand experience and luxury value perceptions drive behavioral responses (Anderson et al. 2025; Luo et al. 2024). Trust and source credibility enhance message acceptance (Matiza and Slabbert 2024; Wen et al. 2025; Yin et al. 2024). Persuasion knowledge and advertising literacy influence responses when commercial intent is recognized (Andreva et al. 2025). Perceived authenticity and expertise further affect competence evaluations (Kim and Baek 2025; Yang, Han, et al. 2025; Yang, Wang, et al. 2025). These mediators shows that SMIs’ video content affects consumer behavior through emotional attachment, trust, competence judgments, and awareness of persuasion.

3.2.3.4 | Dependent Variable. The literature identifies 72 dependent variables across 112 studies, grouped into five categories measuring SMIs’ effectiveness. Behavioral and purchase outcomes assess actions such as purchase intention, sales performance, and travel intention (Luo et al. 2024; Matiza and Slabbert 2024; Wen et al. 2025). Attitudinal outcomes measure perceptions such as trustworthiness and brand attitude (Cheng and Zhang 2025; Li, Kim, et al. 2025). Engagement metrics capture likes, comments, and shares (Wang et al. 2025; Liao and Chen 2024). Experiential and emotional outcomes examine emotional connections and subjective experiences (Anderson et al. 2025). Socio-cultural outcomes address broader effects such as cultural adoption and body image impacts (Pryde et al. 2024). This categorization establishes a comprehensive outcome taxonomy linking commercial, psychological, and societal effects, reflecting the multidimensional impact of SMIs’ video content.

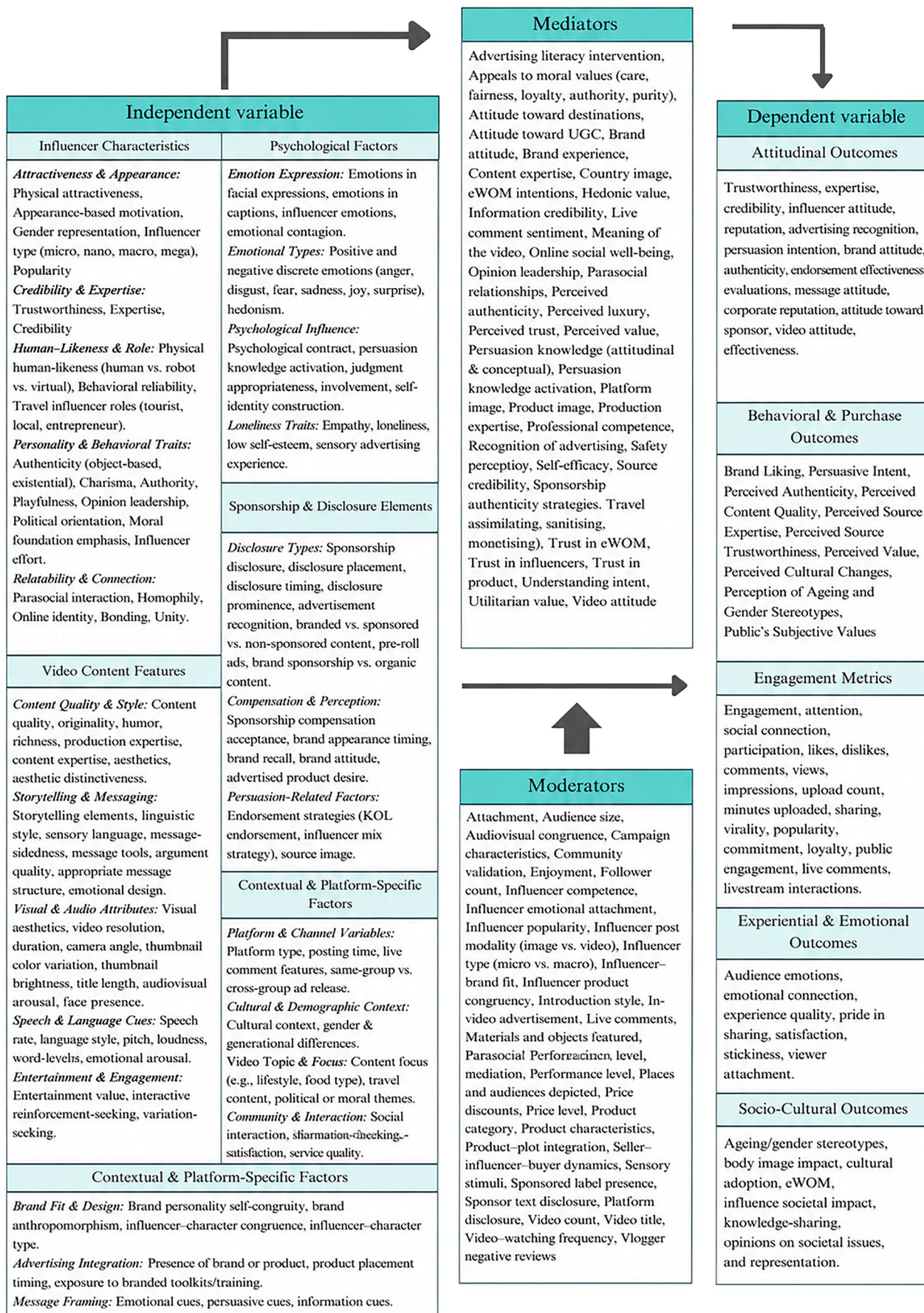


FIGURE 8 | Integrated framework for characteristics. Source: Author's elaboration.

TABLE 7 | List of methodologies.

Research method	Analysis technique	No. of Studies
Quantitative study	Audio analysis, big data analysis, CB-SEM, computer vision, deep learning, endogenous treatment model, experimental design, eye tracking, field experiment, Markov decision process, multimodal machine learning, natural language processing, negative binomial model, OLS regression, online experiment, online questionnaire, online survey with SEM, panel data regression, questionnaire-based survey, quasi-experimental matching, regression modeling, scenario-based experiments, semantic network modeling, sentiment analysis, social media analytics, structural equation modeling, survey, text mining, topic modeling, video analytics.	77
Qualitative study	CAQDAS, content analysis, critical video analysis, inductive thematic analysis, Leximancer analysis, Linguistic Inquiry and Word Count (LIWC) software, netnography, qualitative deductive thematic analysis, qualitative focus group, semi-structured interviews, survey with Burke's Pentadic analysis, survey with qualitative interviews, text analysis.	18
Mixed method Study	Archival data analysis, canonical correlation analysis (CCA), comparative cultural analysis, content analysis, controlled experiment, eye-tracking, experimental research, exploratory factor analysis (EFA), exploratory sequential design, field study, fuzzy-set qualitative comparative analysis (fsQCA), large-scale dataset analysis, multi-method research design, qualitative interviews, semi-structured interviews, speech-to-text, structural equation modeling (SEM), survey, video analysis.	14
Review method	—	3

Source: Author's elaboration.

3.2.4 | Method (M)

Methods refer to the structured ways in which data is gathered and examined within empirical research (Kumar and Ranjani 2025; Lim, Donkers, et al. 2021; Lim, Yap, and Makkar 2021). The existing studies predominantly rely on quantitative methods using experimental approaches, surveys, SEM techniques, and machine learning analytics, as shown in Table 7 (Appendix S7), which represent 68% of all studies (e.g., Matiza and Slabbert 2024; Lee and Wan 2023). Qualitative approaches account for 16%, exploring motivational and experiential dimensions through techniques such as netnography, narrative analysis, and thematic analysis (e.g., Pryde et al. 2024; Aquino and Cabalquinto 2025; Motahar et al. 2024). Mixed-method designs represent 13%, combining quantitative and qualitative techniques such as video dataset analysis with semi-structured interviews and field studies with controlled experiments (e.g., Yang, Han, et al. 2025; Yang, Wang, et al. 2025; Zhang and Tian 2025). Review studies constitute 3%. Research on SMIs videos primarily relies on quantitative methodology, yet emerging advanced computation methods alongside recent implementation of rich qualitative ethnographic methods signal a shift towards more expansive and complex studies.

4 | Future Research Direction

Building on the work of Paul and Menzies (2023), this study identifies potential research gaps by synthesising insights from a framework-based review. To uncover key gaps and emerging areas for future avenues, three researchers independently reviewed each article's abstract, findings, implications, and suggested future directions, following the approach of Lim

et al. (2022). Through multiple rounds of discussion and collaborative brainstorming, the authors developed a set of well-founded future research, presented in Table 8 (Anoop and Rahman 2025).

From a theoretical standpoint, SMIs video research currently relies on a narrow set of theoretical foundations and would benefit from broader conceptual integration. Existing studies have primarily relied on consumer behavior, psychology, and communication theories (Paul and Feliciano-Cestero 2021), while information systems and technology-oriented frameworks remain underexplored. Integrating Decision Support Systems Theory and Information Theory with Parasocial Interaction Theory and the Persuasion Knowledge Model can state how information quality shapes emotional attachment and audience satisfaction (Paul and Rosado-Serrano 2019). Such integration enables a more comprehensive understanding of how technological affordances interact with psychological and social influence processes in digital video environments.

Contextually, current research shows several limitations that require broader examination. Most studies focus on China and the United States, limiting generalizability despite the rapid growth of influencer marketing and video adoption in countries such as India (25% annual growth; Statista 2024), Indonesia (107.7 million TikTok users), and Brazil (91.75 million TikTok users) (Buffer. 2025). The literature is also skewed toward macro- and mega-influencers, while nano-influencers, that account for 75.9% of Instagram SMI accounts and are preferred by 44% of brands are remain underexplored (Influencer Marketing Hub 2025b). Platform diversity is another gap. Scholarship largely centers on YouTube for long-form content (Rohde and Mau 2021) and TikTok for short-form videos (Li and Sun 2024), while formats such as Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, and

LinkedIn short videos receive limited academic attention (Ye et al. 2024). Industry coverage is similarly narrow, with emphasis on tourism (Filieri et al. 2023; Gholamhosseinzadeh 2023), beauty (Gong and Holiday 2023; Haines et al. 2023), and food (Coates et al. 2020). Wherein emerging domains including political communication, entertainment, and metaverse experiences remain insufficiently examined (Dwivedi et al. 2023; Kaur et al. 2023; Tan et al. 2023). Additionally, in-depth interviews revealed two emerging themes that have scope for future researchers: influencer collaborations and podcast-style videos. Influencer collaborations grounded in shared values may enhance perceived authenticity and willingness to pay premium prices (Statista 2025b). Podcast formats, characterized by extended storytelling, foster deeper relational engagement. These developments open avenues to examine networked credibility, authenticity formation, and parasocial dynamics in evolving digital ecosystems.

Regarding SMI characteristics, research must extend beyond basic demographic or credibility traits toward technology-enabled features. Variables such as algorithmic optimization tools, video enhancement features, interactive elements, and customized visual design warrant closer examination (Lee and Theokary 2021). Platform-specific affordances may also shape perceptions of credibility and attractiveness, particularly as virtual reality and artificial intelligence reshape content production. Cross-cultural investigations are equally important, as authenticity perceptions may vary across cultural norms and value systems.

From a methodological perspective, research in this area would benefit from combining qualitative and quantitative approaches. Studies that integrate ethnographic methods with large-scale analytics can capture both cultural context and audience behavior. Techniques such as multimodal sentiment analysis and audio–visual data integration can provide more detailed insights into engagement patterns. In addition, tools like EEG and eye-tracking allow researchers to measure real-time cognitive and emotional responses, offering a deeper understanding of how audiences process and react to SMI video content.

5 | Theoretical Implications

The study provides five important theoretical implications. Firstly, while prior studies have explored various dynamics of SMIs, limited attention has been given to video content, a rapidly growing format in the digital marketplace, driven by the expansion of short-form and long-form video platforms. Recognizing the increasing dominance of video content in social media marketing, this study provides a timely and necessary expansion of the theoretical landscape. TCCM (Theory, Context, Characteristics, Methodology) framework. By enriching the model, this study offers a deeper, value-added synthesis of the existing body of knowledge. Within the TCCM framework, thematic analysis is strengthened through a novel methodological approach that combines topic modelling with in-depth expert interviews, providing both quantitative and qualitative insights. The integrative approach bridges theoretical insights to practical implementation, thus creating paths for researchers to improve theoretical-practical framework alignment. Thirdly, this

study makes theoretical progress through its examination of the persuasive impact of influencer-sponsored content by using established frameworks, that is, the Persuasion Knowledge Model combined with Parasocial Relationships Theory, alongside Source Credibility Theory. These frameworks function as an essential theoretical approach to understand how SMIs video content influences consumer engagement, trust, and purchase behaviors. The research suggests introducing existing contemporary theories, such as Media Richness Theory and Emotional Contagion Theory, to depict digital video interactions that are increasingly immersive and emotionally powerful. Furthermore, this study provides the systematic variable taxonomy for the consumer behavior domain in digital video contexts through a comprehensive classification of 117 independent variables, 38 moderators, 40 mediators, and 72 dependent variables. This study provides significant findings that link crucial variables that influence SMIs effectiveness and audience interaction through its structured variable classifications. Lastly, the study makes a broader impact on consumer behavior literature by demonstrating how multimodal elements of video influence attitudes, trust formation, and purchase intention, offering a richer understanding of how consumers process and respond to SMIs' video content.

6 | Managerial Implications

A systematized literature review utilizing the TCCM framework provides valuable insights for businesses, marketers, agencies, and SMIs engaging with SMIs' video content. The findings highlight what types of video content drive the most engagement, trust, and purchase intention. Brands can better align their personality with platform-specific content attributes, while marketers can gain insights into strategies that foster authentic connections and emotional bonds with consumers. SMIs' marketing agencies can enhance SMIs' selection, improve campaign planning, and systematically evaluate content effectiveness. SMIs and creators can also benefit by understanding which video attributes strengthen viewer trust and interest, as well as by leveraging analytics tools such as sentiment analysis and performance metrics to align content with audience preferences.

The review further emphasizes several critical managerial implications. Different video formats serve distinct purposes: short-form videos like TikTok, Reels, and Shorts capture attention quickly, while long-form formats such as livestreams and podcasts build authenticity, depth, and community. Transparency through sponsorship disclosures, affiliate codes, and partnerships not only meets regulatory requirements but also enhances trust and engagement when integrated naturally into narratives. Established and emerging themes like sustainable fashion storytelling, parasocial relationships, and influencer-to-influencer collaborations demonstrate how brands can align with consumer values, amplify authenticity, and expand reach. Moreover, evidence-based variables such as trust, authenticity, emotional connection, and engagement cues provide managers with practical strategies to design and assess campaigns effectively. Since responses to SMIs' video content differ across platforms and cultural contexts, managers are encouraged to adapt strategies to specific affordances and audience expectations. Collectively, these insights form a practical blueprint for building impactful

TABLE 8 | Future research directions for SMI video content using TCCM framework.

Category	Future research directions
THEORY (T)	
Technology-driven perspectives	• Explore how the use of augmented reality (AR) and virtual reality (VR) in SMIs video content impact viewer immersion and consumer behavior (Example: Theory of Immersion, Technology Acceptance Model) • Explore how advancements in artificial intelligence and machine learning influence the personalization and targeting of SMIs video content, and what are the implications for audience engagement (Example: Media Personalization Theory, Technological Determinism)
Social psychology	• How can social contagion theory and social compensation theory be extended to explain the role of parasocial interaction in fostering follower stickiness with SMIs? • How does signaling theory explain the role of beauty and face presence in livestreaming commerce and user-generated videos?
CONTEXT (C)	
Country	• Investigate how technological barriers affect the accessibility and effectiveness of SMIs videos among rural populations in countries like India, addressing the digital divide and localized marketing strategies • Examine how SMIs-generated videos impact political opinions and voter behavior in diverse nations, considering factors such as regional, demographic, and cultural differences • Future research could compare SMIs marketing strategies across Western and Eastern cultures to examine how gender, cultural norms, and platform regulations shape video content and audience response
Influencer type	• How do cross-platform spillover effects and sponsorship effects vary across influencer sizes (nano, micro, macro) and industries? • How can nano-influencers leverage parasocial interaction attributes in video content to sustain higher levels of audience engagement compared to micro- and macro-influencers?
Video type	• Examine the immersive and sensory experiences of livestream platforms, the role of real-time interaction, and how built-in monetization/reward systems impact both viewer behavior and streamer performance • Does audiovisual congruence vary across short video platforms and industries?
Platform type	• Investigate the algorithmic visibility of content on platforms like Instagram Reels versus YouTube Shorts impact SMIs reach and engagement • Examine how user demographics and content formats (stories, reels) on platforms like Snapchat Spotlight versus Instagram Reels affect SMIs content style, tone, and credibility
Industry focused	• Explore the impact of music and video modifications on audience engagement and travel intentions • Examine how SMIs fashion videos create a sense of urgency and FOMO (Fear of Missing Out) among viewers, leading to fast-paced fashion consumption • How do SMIs profiles perform across industries (fashion, tourism, tech, B2B)?
Themes	
Sustainability fashion	• How can sustainable fashion SMIs balance commercial sponsorship with authenticity and ethical values to avoid greenwashing while still driving consumer engagement?
Livestream videos	• How do real-time cues in SMIs livestreams (e.g., audience comments, emoji reactions, gifting features) dynamically alter persuasion outcomes and shape impulse purchase behavior?

(Continues)

TABLE 8 | (Continued)

Category	Future research directions
Short form video	How do editing techniques such as music choice, pacing, and visual filters interact with SMIs credibility to shape consumer attention and purchase intention in short-form videos?
Brand collaborations & disclosure	How do self-disclosure practices (e.g., sharing personal struggles, daily routines) and interactivity (polls, Q&A) jointly contribute to the development of parasocial bonds and consumer loyalty over time?
Parasocial relationship	How do varying levels of transparency in brand–influencer collaborations (e.g., explicit “paid partnership” tags vs. subtle product placement) influence consumer perceptions of authenticity and long-term brand loyalty?
Influencer to influencer collaboration	- Examine the types of followers exchanged during influencer-to-influencer collaborations and assess how these exchanges influence engagement metrics, audience retention, and follower loyalty - Investigate how collaborations between human and virtual influencers shape consumer perceptions of innovation, technological appeal, and brand authenticity, and how these perceptions affect purchase intentions - Investigate how language use, cultural symbolism, and shared values within intercultural SMIs collaborations influence consumer interpretation, emotional connection, and response to branded content
Podcast video	- What is the comparative effectiveness of product integration strategies in SMIs podcast videos versus conventional sponsored content in terms of conversion rates and audience acceptance? - How do podcast videos transform the quality of influencer-audience interactions and community building in digital marketing contexts? - What role do extended storytelling formats in podcast videos play in developing stronger parasocial relationships between SMIs and their audiences?
CHARACTERISTICS (C)	
Authenticity & trust	- Explore how authenticity and transparency of virtual influencers videos impact consumer trust and engagement compared to human influencers in various digital environments like augmented reality (AR) and virtual reality (VR) - What authenticity strategies (transparency, immediacy, ordinariness, passion) are most persuasive across different cultural contexts?
Social responsibility & ethics	Studies can understand what role ethical alignment and social responsibility play in shaping consumer loyalty and purchase intentions in SMIs video, especially among Gen Z and millennial audiences
Visual & technical features	Studies can explore how visual cues, video length, and audience demographics influence engagement with SMIs video content in real-world settings
Influencer traits	Which SMIs traits (e.g., attractiveness, empathy, consistency) most strongly foster long-term follower stickiness?
METHODOLOGY (M)	
Text & content analysis	- Explore how sentiment analysis can be leveraged to decode the meaning and impact of emojis in video captions and comments - Use Netnography to explore how emerging digital cultures and communities influence viewer engagement with SMIs video content
Machine learning & AI	How can multimodal machine learning (computer vision, NLP) and big data analytics be scaled to decode SMIs video features, beauty, and persuasion?
Multimodal analysis	Investigate cross-modality integration techniques (e.g., combining visual and auditory stimuli) to study their effect on consumer perception in SMIs marketin
Experimental methods	Future researchers could use eye-tracking, EEG, field log data, and cognitive recall tasks to understand attention, engagement, and memory in response to SMIs' video content.

Source: Author's compilation from literature review and future research questions.

SMIs video campaigns that strengthen consumer trust, engagement, and purchase intention.

7 | Conclusion

This study presents a systematic review of SMIs' video content using a multimethod approach. A total of 112 research articles were synthesized through the TCCM framework. The literature was structured by identifying key theories, contextual factors (such as country, platform, SMIs type, and themes), characteristics, and methodologies. Themes within the context were derived by integrating topic modeling techniques with insights from in-depth expert interviews. Building on these findings, the study proposes future research directions to further advance the literature on SMIs' video content.

8 | Limitations of the Study

This study provides a comprehensive synthesis of the literature on the impact of SMIs' videos on consumer behavior. However, it also carries a few limitations. First, the paper relies solely on the Scopus database, while relevant articles may exist in other databases or regions beyond Scopus. This reliance could limit the findings to easily accessible or indexed publications, particularly high-impact scholarly journals. Second, by restricting the inclusion criteria to English-language publications, the study may have overlooked significant contributions from non-English markets. This constraint reduces the global generalisability of the findings, as valuable insights from diverse cultural and linguistic contexts may not have been captured.

Conflicts of Interest

The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

Data Availability Statement

Data sharing not applicable to this article as no datasets were generated or analysed during the current study.

References

- Agrawal, S. R., and D. Mittal. 2025. "Optimizing Marketing Strategy: A Video Analysis Approach." *Marketing Intelligence & Planning* 43, no. 1: 73–95.
- Ambika, A., H. Shin, and V. Jain. 2025. "Immersive Technologies and Consumer Behavior: A Systematic Review of Two Decades of Research." *Australian Journal of Management* 50, no. 1: 55–79.
- Anderson, K. C., K. A. Wallach, P. A. Albinsson, and R. Tracy. 2025. "From Body Positivity and Beyond: Investigating Affective Aesthetic Atmospheres of Influencers." *Journal of Consumer Behaviour* 24, no. 3: 1373–1391.
- Andreeva, I., M. Taggart, T. A. Lattimer, et al. 2025. "Investigating the Moral Justification and Online Engagement Strategies Used by Extremist Right-Wing and Left-Wing TikTok Influencers." *American Behavioral Scientist*: 27642251344214.
- Anoop, T. S., and Z. Rahman. 2025. "Online Impulse Buying: A Systematic Review of 25 Years of Research Using Meta Regression." *Journal of Consumer Behaviour* 24, no. 1: 363–391.
- Aquino, R. S., and E. C. B. Cabalquinto. 2025. "Travel Vlogging as an Integrated Practice: Foreign Travel Vloggers' Practices in The Philippines." *Annals of Tourism Research* 111, no. 103: 897.
- Arnold, A. 2017. "Four Ways Social Media Influences Millennials' Purchase Decisions." *Forbes*. <https://www.forbes.com/sites/andrear-nold/2017/12/22/4-ways-social-media-influences-millennials-purchasing-decisions/>.
- Aw, E. C. X., and R. Agnihotri. 2024. "Influencer Marketing Research: Review and Future Research Agenda." *Journal of Marketing Theory and Practice* 32, no. 4: 435–448.
- Barari, M. M., M. Eisend, and S. P. Jain. 2025. "A Meta-Analysis of the Effectiveness of Social Media Influencers: Mechanisms and Moderation." *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science* 54: 1–21.
- Bargoni, A., C. Giachino, R. Gutuleac, and D. Streimikiene. 2024. "Is This Really Me? Investigating Brand Personality Self-Congruity on Consumer Behavior in Video-Based Social Media." *Psychology & Marketing* 41, no. 5: 1115–1132.
- Baron, R. M., and D. A. Kenny. 1986. "The Moderator–mediator Variable Distinction in Social Psychological Research: Conceptual, Strategic, and Statistical Considerations." *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 51, no. 6: 1173.
- Barta, S., D. Belanche, A. Fernández, and M. Flavián. 2023. "Influencer Marketing on TikTok: The Effectiveness of Humor and Followers' Hedonic Experience." *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* 70, no. 103: 149.
- Beuckels, E., and R. de Wolf. 2025. "Social Media Influencers as New Agents on Parenthood? A Systematic Literature Review of Parent Influencer Research and a Future Research Agenda." *Information, Communication & Society* 28, no. 4: 744–762.
- Bhardwaj, S., N. Kumar, R. Gupta, H. Baber, and A. Venkatesh. 2024. "How Social Media Influencers Impact Consumer Behaviour? Systematic Literature Review." *Vision*, 09722629241237394.
- Bhukya, R., J. Paul, M. Kastanakis, and S. Robinson. 2022. "Forty Years of European Management Journal: A Bibliometric Overview." *European Management Journal* 40, no. 1: 10–28.
- Blei, D. M., A. Y. Ng, and M. I. Jordan. 2003. "Latent Dirichlet Allocation." *Journal of Machine Learning Research* 3, no. Jan: 993–1022.
- Boerman, S. C., E. Rozendaal, and E. A. van Reijmersdal. 2024. "The Development and Testing of a Pictogram Signaling Advertising in Online Videos." *International Journal of Advertising* 43, no. 4: 672–691.
- Boerman, S. C., and E. A. van Reijmersdal. 2020. "Disclosing Influencer Marketing on YouTube to Children: The Moderating Role of Para-Social Relationship." *Frontiers in Psychology* 10: 3042.
- Braun, V., and V. Clarke. 2006. "Using Thematic Analysis in Psychology." *Qualitative Research in Psychology* 3, no. 2: 77–101.
- Broadbridge, V., F. Mangió, and G. di Domenico. 2023. "How Brand Managers Can Maximize Engagement With ASMR YouTube Content: Influencers Who Give You the "Tingles" Through Autonomous Sensory Meridian Response Cues." *Journal of Advertising Research* 63, no. 4: 313–334.
- Buffer. 2025. *31 TikTok Statistics to Know for 2025*. Buffer. <https://buffer.com/resources/tiktok-statistics/>.
- Castonguay, J. 2022. "Influencers' Disclosures of Advertising and Responses From Youth With Varying Levels of Theory of Mind." *Journal of Current Issues and Research in Advertising* 43, no. 3: 237–255.
- Chan, T. H., K. Hung, and D. K. Tse. 2023. "Comparing E-Commerce Micro-and Macroinfluencers in TikTok Videos: Effects of Strategies on Audience Likes, Audience Shares, and Brand Sales." *Journal of Interactive Advertising* 23, no. 4: 307–322.

- Chen, C. W., D. T. T. Nguyen, M. Chih, and P. Y. Chen. 2024. "Fostering YouTube Followers' Stickiness Through Social Contagion: The Role of Digital Influencer' Characteristics and Followers' Compensation Psychology." *Computers in Human Behavior* 158, no. 108: 304.
- Chen, H., C. Lou, Y. Wang, and Y. Lee. 2025. "Social Virtual Influencer Effectiveness: Environmental Factor and Source Trust." *Social Marketing Quarterly* 31, no. 3: 199–219.
- Chen, L., Y. Chen, and Y. Pan. 2024. "The Effect of Sponsored Video Customization on Video Shares: The Critical Moderating Role of Influencer and Brand Characteristics." *European Journal of Marketing* 58, no. 4: 1047–1082.
- Chen, L., Y. Yan, and A. N. Smith. 2023. "What Drives Digital Engagement With Sponsored Videos? An Investigation of Video Influencers' Authenticity Management Strategies." *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science* 51, no. 1: 198–221.
- Chen, Y., T. Mandler, and L. Meyer-Waarden. 2021. "Three Decades of Research on Loyalty Programs: A Literature Review and Future Research Agenda." *Journal of Business Research* 124: 179–197.
- Cheng, M., and S. Zhang. 2025. "Reputation Burning: Analyzing the Impact of Brand Sponsorship on Social Influencers." *Management Science* 71, no. 7: 5910–5932.
- Coates, A. E., C. A. Hardman, J. C. G. Halford, P. Christiansen, and E. J. Boyland. 2020. "It's Just Addictive People That Make Addictive Videos: Children's Understanding of and Attitudes Towards Influencer Marketing of Food and Beverages by YouTube Video Bloggers." *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health* 17, no. 2: 449.
- Dam, L., A. M. B. Borsai, and B. Burroughs. 2024. "(Over) Eating With Our Eyes: An Examination of Mukbang Influencer Marketing and Consumer Engagement With Food Brands." *Journal of Promotion Management* 30, no. 2: 227–251.
- De Jans, S., V. Cauberghe, and L. Hudders. 2018. "How an Advertising Disclosure Alerts Young Adolescents to Sponsored Vlogs: The Moderating Role of a Peer-Based Advertising Literacy Intervention Through an Informational Vlog." *Journal of Advertising* 47, no. 4: 309–325.
- Djafarova, E., and C. Rushworth. 2017. "Exploring the Credibility of Online Celebrities' Instagram Profiles in Influencing the Purchase Decisions of Young Female Users." *Computers in Human Behavior* 68: 1–7.
- Dwivedi, Y. K., L. Hughes, Y. Wang, et al. 2023. "Metaverse Marketing: How the Metaverse Will Shape the Future of Consumer Research and Practice." *Psychology & Marketing* 40, no. 4: 750–776.
- Evangelopoulos, N. 2015. "Thematic Orientation of the ISJ Within a Semantic Space of IS Research." *Information Systems Journal* 26, no. 1: 39–46.
- Evans, N. J., M. G. Hoy, and C. C. Childers. 2018. "Parenting 'YouTube Natives': The Impact of Pre-Roll Advertising and Text Disclosures on Parental Responses to Sponsored Child Influencer Videos." *Journal of Advertising* 47, no. 4: 326–346.
- Filieri, R., F. Acikgoz, and H. Du. 2023. "Electronic Word-Of-Mouth From Video Bloggers: The Role of Content Quality and Source Homophily Across Hedonic and Utilitarian Products." *Journal of Business Research* 160: 113,774.
- Follmer, K. B., and K. S. Jones. 2018. "Mental Illness in the Workplace: An Interdisciplinary Review and Organizational Research Agenda." *Journal of Management* 44, no. 1: 325–351.
- Fong, S. F., Y. X. Ong, R. Ating, and M. S. Besa. 2025. "Exploring the Intermediary Effects of TikTok on Generation Z's Visit Intention." *Journal of Vacation Marketing* 31, no. 3: 736–752.
- Forbes. 2025. "How the Creator Economy Is Reshaping Modern Marketing—And Why Brands Are Paying Attention." Forbes, June 16, 2025. <https://www.forbes.com/sites/lowes-creator/2025/06/16/how-the-creator-economy-is-reshaping-modern-marketing-and-why-brands-are-paying-attention/>.
- Ford, J., V. Jain, K. Wadhvani, and D. G. Gupta. 2023. "AI Advertising: An Overview and Guidelines." *Journal of Business Research* 166: 114–124.
- Fowler, K., and V. L. Thomas. 2023. "Influencer Marketing: A Scoping Review and a Look Ahead." *Journal of Marketing Management* 39, no. 11–12: 933–964.
- Freberg, K., K. Graham, K. McGaughey, and L. A. Freberg. 2011. "Who Are the Social Media Influencers? A Study of Public Perceptions of Personality." *Public Relations Review* 37, no. 1: 90–92.
- García-de-Frutos, N., and A. Estrella-Ramón. 2021. "You Absolutely (Don't) Need This! Examining Differences on Customer Engagement Components for (Anti) Haul Youtubers' Videos." *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing* 15, no. 1: 86–103.
- Garrido-Pintado, P., D. Cordon-Benito, and L. Maestro-Espinola. 2022. "Digital Audio and Programmatic Ad Buying: Status and Prospects in the Post-Pandemic Context." *Profesional de la Información* 31, no. 5: e310511.
- Gaston-Breton, C., and M. C. De Stefano. 2025. "Mapping Consumer Well-Being: Contextualization, Conceptualization, and Classification Using Topic Modeling." *Journal of Business Research* 194: 115350.
- Ge, J., Y. Sui, X. Zhou, and G. Li. 2021. "Effect of Short Video Ads on Sales Through Social Media: The Role of Advertisement Content Generators." *International Journal of Advertising* 40, no. 6: 870–896.
- Gholamhosseinzadeh, M. S. 2023. "Theorizing Vloggers' Approaches and Practices in Travel Vlog Production Through Grounded Theory." *Journal of Hospitality Marketing & Management* 32, no. 2: 196–223.
- Gong, Z. H., and S. Holiday. 2023. "Parasocial Interaction Message Elements and Disclosure Timing in Nano-and Microinfluencers' Sponsored Content as Alternative Explanations for Follower Count's Influence on Engagement." *Journal of Interactive Advertising* 23, no. 4: 374–387.
- Gu, X., X. Zhang, and P. K. Kannan. 2024. "Influencer Mix Strategies in Livestream Commerce: Impact on Product Sales." *Journal of Marketing* 88, no. 4: 64–83.
- Gupta, D. G., H. Shin, and V. Jain. 2022. "Luxury Experience and Consumer Behavior: A Literature Review." *Marketing Intelligence & Planning* 41, no. 2: 199–213.
- Gupta, R., R. Pandey, and V. J. Sebastian. 2021. "International Entrepreneurial Orientation (IEO): A Bibliometric Overview of Scholarly Research." *Journal of Business Research* 125: 74–88.
- Haines, S., O. H. Fares, M. Mohan, and S. H. Lee. 2023. "Social Media Fashion Influencer eWOM Communications: Understanding the Trajectory of Sustainable Fashion Conversations on YouTube Fashion Haul Videos." *Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management: An International Journal* 27, no. 6: 1027–1046.
- Han, J., and G. Balabanis. 2024. "Meta-analysis of Social Media Influencer Impact: Key Antecedents and Theoretical Foundations." *Psychology & Marketing* 41, no. 2: 394–426.
- Harnish, R. J., and K. R. Bridges. 2016. "Mall Haul Videos: Self-Presentational Motives and the Role of Self-Monitoring." *Psychology & Marketing* 33, no. 2: 113–124.
- Harrigan, P., T. M. Daly, K. Coussement, J. A. Lee, G. N. Soutar, and U. Evers. 2021. "Identifying Influencers on Social Media." *International Journal of Information Management* 56: 102–246.
- Hennink, M., and B. N. Kaiser. 2022. "Sample Sizes for Saturation in Qualitative Research: A Systematic Review of Empirical Tests." *Social Science & Medicine* 292: 114523.
- HubSpot. 2024. "How Video Consumption is Changing: 2024 Insights." January 11, 2024. <https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/how-video-consumption-is-changing>.

- Hung, K., D. K. Tse, and T. H. Chan. 2022. "E-Commerce Influencers in China: Dual-Route Model on Likes, Shares, and Sales." *Journal of Advertising* 51, no. 4: 486–501.
- Hunt, S. D. 2018. "Advancing Marketing Strategy in the Marketing Discipline and Beyond: From Promise, to Neglect, to Prominence, to Fragment (To Promise?)" *Journal of Marketing Management* 34, no. 1–2: 16–51.
- Influencer Marketing Hub. 2025a. "Influencer Marketing Benchmark Report 2025." <https://influencermarketinghub.com/influencer-marketing-benchmark-report>.
- Influencer Marketing Hub. 2025b. "Social Media Statistics." <https://influencermarketinghub.com/social-media-statistics/>.
- Jain, V., K. Wadhvani, and J. K. Eastman. 2024. "Artificial Intelligence Consumer Behavior: A Hybrid Review and Research Agenda." *Journal of Consumer Behaviour* 23, no. 2: 676–697.
- Jain, V., J. Wirtz, P. Salunke, R. Nunkoo, and A. Sharma. 2023. "Luxury Hospitality: A Systematic Literature Review and Research Agenda." *International Journal of Hospitality Management* 115: 103,597.
- Jiang, L., X. Chen, S. Miao, and C. Shi. 2024. "Play It Safe or Leave the Comfort Zone? Optimal Content Strategies for Social Media Influencers on Streaming Video Platforms." *Decision Support Systems* 179: 114,148.
- Johnson, B. K., A. S. Bradshaw, J. Davis, et al. 2022. "Credible Influencers." *Journal of Media Psychology* 34, no. 4: 236–248.
- Joshi, Y., W. M. Lim, K. Jagani, and S. Kumar. 2025. "Social Media Influencer Marketing: Foundations, Trends, and Ways Forward." *Electronic Commerce Research* 25, no. 2: 1199–1253.
- Kaur, J., E. Mogaji, M. Paliwal, S. Jha, S. Agarwal, and S. A. Mogaji. 2023. "Consumer Behavior in the Metaverse." *Journal of Consumer Behaviour* 23: 1720–1738.
- Khamis, S., L. Ang, and R. Welling. 2017. "Self-Branding, 'Micro-Celebrity' and the Rise of Social Media Influencers." *Celebrity Studies* 8, no. 2: 191–208.
- Kim, E., M. Duffy, and E. Thorson. 2021. "Under the Influence: Social Media Influencers' Impact on Response to Corporate Reputation Advertising." *Journal of Advertising* 50, no. 2: 119–138.
- Kim, E., and Y. Kim. 2022. "Factors Affecting the Attitudes and Behavioral Intentions of Followers Toward Advertising Content Embedded Within YouTube Influencers' Videos." *Journal of Promotion Management* 28, no. 8: 1235–1256.
- Kim, H., and H. J. Choo. 2023. "How 'K-Style' Has Influenced the Younger Generation Through Local Vietnamese Influencers." *Fashion and Textiles* 10, no. 1: 40.
- Kim, M., and T. H. Baek. 2025. "Expertise and Playfulness of Social Media Influencers." *Journal of Current Issues & Research in Advertising* 46, no. 1: 19–39.
- Kumar, A., and K. S. Ranjani. 2025. "Consumer Investment Behaviour: A Systematic Review Using TCM and ADO Frameworks." *International Journal of Consumer Studies* 49, no. 5: e70110.
- Ladhari, R., E. Massa, and H. Skandrani. 2020. "YouTube Vloggers' Popularity and Influence: The Roles of Homophily, Emotional Attachment, and Expertise." *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* 54: 102,027.
- Landsberg, N. 2021. "60 Powerful Video Marketing Statistics (pWhy You Should Use Video)". <https://influencermarketinghub.com/video-marketing-statistics/>.
- Lee, D., and C. Wan. 2023. "The Impact of Mukbang Live Streaming Commerce on Consumers' Overconsumption Behavior." *Journal of Interactive Marketing* 58, no. 2–3: 198–221.
- Lee, J. E., and B. Watkins. 2016. "YouTube Vloggers' Influence on Consumer Luxury Brand Perceptions and Intentions." *Journal of Business Research* 69, no. 12: 5753–5760.
- Lee, M. T., and C. Theokary. 2021. "The Superstar Social Media Influencer: Exploiting Linguistic Style and Emotional Contagion Over Content?" *Journal of Business Research* 132: 860–871.
- Li, J., Y. Wang, Y. Lin, Y. Jiang, and Q. Yang. 2025. "The Power of Sound: The Impact of Auditory Features in Hotel Short Influencer-Generated Videos on Viewer Engagement." *International Journal of Hospitality Management* 131: 104,341.
- Li, M. W., Y. R. Kim, A. Liu, C. Scarles, and J. L. Chen. 2025. "Storytelling in Travel Vlogs: Scale Development, Validation, and Application." *Journal of Travel Research* 65, no. 3: 786–811.
- Li, P., and Y. Sun. 2024. "Impact of Internet Celebrities' Short Videos on Audiences' Visit Intentions: Is Beauty Power?" *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications* 11, no. 1: 1–11.
- Liao, J., and J. Chen. 2024. "The Authenticity Advantage: How Influencer Authenticity Management Strategies Shape Digital Engagement With Sponsored Videos." *Journal of Business Research* 185: 114,937.
- Liberati, A., D. G. Altman, J. Tetzlaff, et al. 2009. "The PRISMA Statement for Reporting Systematic Reviews and Meta-Analyses of Studies That Evaluate Health Care Interventions: Explanation and Elaboration." *Annals of Internal Medicine* 151, no. 4: W-65.
- Lim, S., B. Donkers, P. van Dijk, and B. G. Dellaert. 2021. "Digital Customization of Consumer Investments in Multiple Funds: Virtual Integration Improves Risk–Return Decisions." *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science* 49, no. 4: 723–742.
- Lim, W. M., S. Kumar, and F. Ali. 2022. "Advancing Knowledge Through Literature Reviews: 'What', 'Why', and 'How to Contribute'." *Service Industries Journal* 42, no. 7–8: 481–513.
- Lim, W. M., S. F. Yap, and M. Makkar. 2021. "Home Sharing in Marketing and Tourism at a Tipping Point: What Do We Know, How Do We Know, and Where Should We Be Heading?" *Journal of Business Research* 122: 534–566.
- Liu, M. T., Y. Liu, and L. L. Zhang. 2019. "Vlog and Brand Evaluations: The Influence of Parasocial Interaction." *Asia Pacific Journal of Marketing and Logistics* 31, no. 2.
- Lou, C., and S. Yuan. 2019. "Influencer Marketing: How Message Value and Credibility Affect Consumer Trust of Branded Content on Social Media." *Journal of Interactive Advertising* 19, no. 1: 58–73.
- Lu, H. H., C. F. Chen, and Y. W. Tai. 2024. "Exploring the Roles of Vlogger Characteristics and Video Attributes on Followers' Value Perceptions and Behavioral Intention." *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* 77: 103,686.
- Luo, J. M., A. Kong, S. H. G. Chan, and C. F. Lam. 2024. "Hedonism and Opinion Leadership Influence on Consumer Behavior in the Context of First-Class Flights From Short Videos on Social Media." *Journal of Quality Assurance in Hospitality & Tourism*: 1–22.
- Matiza, T., and E. Slabbert. 2024. "The Celebrity Influencer: Delineating the Effect of Tourism-Oriented Short Video Marketing on International Tourist Conation." *Journal of Global Marketing* 37, no. 4: 331–349.
- Meyer, E. A., P. Sandner, B. Cloutier, and I. M. Welp. 2023. "High on Bitcoin: Evidence of Emotional Contagion in the YouTube Crypto Influencer Space." *Journal of Business Research* 164: 113,850.
- Mohammadi, E., and A. Karami. 2022. "Exploring Research Trends in Big Data Across Disciplines: A Text Mining Analysis." *Journal of Information Science* 48, no. 1: 44–56.
- Moher, D., L. Shamseer, M. Clarke, et al. 2015. "Preferred Reporting Items for Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis Protocols (PRISMA-P) 2015 Statement." *Systematic Reviews* 4, no. 1: 1.

- Morais, D., F. Hemme, and C. Reyes. 2022. "Tap 'Follow' FitFam: A Process of Social Media Microcelebrity." *Qualitative Research in Sport, Exercise and Health* 14, no. 2: 289–305.
- Motahar, P. S., R. Tavakoli, and P. Mura. 2024. "Social Media Influencers' Visual Framing of Iran on YouTube." *Tourism Recreation Research* 49, no. 2: 270–282.
- Motta, M., Y. Liu, and A. Yarnell. 2024. "Influencing the Influencers: a Field Experimental Approach to Promoting Effective Mental Health Communication on TikTok." *Scientific Reports* 14, no. 1: 5864.
- Mukherjee, D., W. M. Lim, S. Kumar, and N. Donthu. 2022. "Guidelines for Advancing Theory and Practice Through Bibliometric Research." *Journal of Business Research* 148: 101–115.
- Munaro, A. C., R. H. Barcelos, E. C. F. Maffezzoli, J. P. S. Rodrigues, and E. C. Paraiso. 2024. "Does Your Style Engage? Linguistic Styles of Influencers and Digital Consumer Engagement on YouTube." *Computers in Human Behavior* 156: 108,217.
- O'Neil-Hart, C., and H. Blumenstein. 2016. "The Latest Video Trends: Where Your Audience Is Watching." Think With Google. <https://www.thinkwithgoogle.com/consumer-insights/video-trendswhere-audience-watching>.
- Ooi, K. B., V. H. Lee, J. J. Hew, L. Y. Leong, G. W. H. Tan, and A. F. Lim. 2023. "Social Media Influencers: An Effective Marketing Approach?" *Journal of Business Research* 160: 113,773.
- Pan, M., M. Blut, A. Ghiassaleh, and Z. W. Lee. 2025. "Influencer Marketing Effectiveness: A Meta-Analytic Review." *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science* 53, no. 1: 52–78.
- Pandey, V., and V. Tripathi. 2025. "Four Decades of Sensory Marketing: A Hybrid Review and Future Research Agenda." *International Journal of Consumer Studies* 49, no. 1: e70007.
- Paul, J., and A. R. Criado. 2020. "The Art of Writing Literature Review: What do we Know and What do we Need to Know?" *International Business Review* 29, no. 4: 101717.
- Paul, J., and M. M. Feliciano-Cestero. 2021. "Five Decades of Research on Foreign Direct Investment by MNEs: An Overview and Research Agenda." *Journal of Business Research* 124: 800–812.
- Paul, J., P. Khatri, and H. Kaur Duggal. 2024. "Frameworks for Developing Impactful Systematic Literature Reviews and Theory Building: What, Why and How?" *Journal of Decision Systems* 33, no. 4: 1–14.
- Paul, J., and J. Menzies. 2023. "Developing Classic Systematic Literature Reviews to Advance Knowledge: Dos and Don'ts." *European Management Journal* 41, no. 6: 815–820.
- Paul, J., and A. Rosado-Serrano. 2019. "Gradual Internationalization vs. Born-Global/International New Venture Models: A Review and Research Agenda." *International Marketing Review* 36, no. 6: 830–858.
- Pradhan, B., K. Kishore, and N. Gokhale. 2023. "Social Media Influencers and Consumer Engagement: A Review and Future Research Agenda." *International Journal of Consumer Studies* 47, no. 6: 2106–2130.
- Pryde, S., E. Kempes, and I. Prichard. 2024. "You Started Working Out to Get a Flat Stomach and a Fat a \$\$: A Content Analysis of Fitpiration Videos on TikTok." *Body Image* 51: 101769.
- Pushparaj, P., and B. P. Kushwaha. 2024. "Social Media Influencer Marketing: A Systematic Literature Review Using TCM and ADO Framework." *International Journal of Consumer Studies* 48, no. 6: e13098.
- Qiu, L., X. Li, and S. H. Choi. 2024. "Exploring the Influence of Short Video Platforms on Tourist Attitudes and Travel Intention: A Social-Technical Perspective." *Journal of Destination Marketing & Management* 31: 100826.
- Ray, R. K., I. Vyas, R. Chandwani, and M. Kumar. 2026. "Mental Health Consumption: Tracing the Past and Preparing for the Future in a Digital Age." *Journal of Consumer Behaviour* 25, no. 1: 444–463.
- Rizomyliotis, I., C. L. Lin, K. Konstantoulaki, and T. Phan. 2024. "TikTok Short Video Marketing and Gen Z's Purchase Intention: Evidence From the Cosmetics Industry in Singapore." *Journal of Asia Business Studies* 18, no. 4: 930–945.
- Rohde, P., and G. Mau. 2021. "It's Selling Like Hotcakes": Deconstructing Social Media Influencer Marketing in Long-Form Video Content on Youtube via Social Influence Heuristics." *European Journal of Marketing* 55, no. 10: 2700–2734.
- Sağkaya Gungor, A., T. Ozansoy Çadırcı, Ş. G. Köse, and E. Özer Çizer. 2024. "Consumer Responses Toward Smart Technology: A Systematic Review, Synthesis, and Future Research Agenda." *International Journal of Consumer Studies* 48, no. 3: e13048.
- Saima, and M. A. Khan. 2020. "Effect of Social Media Influencer Marketing on Consumers' Purchase Intention and the Mediating Role of Credibility." *Journal of Promotion Management* 27, no. 4: 503–523.
- Salunke, P., V. Jain, J. Eastman, T. Mishra, and A. Chakraborty. 2025. "Decoding the Effectiveness of Social Media Influencers' Endorsement on Consumer Behavior: An Evidence-Based Approach." *Electronic Commerce Research* 25, no. 3: 1–37.
- Sardar, S., and T. S. Vijay. 2025. "Social Media Influencers and Purchase Intention: A Review and Research Agenda." *International Journal of Consumer Studies* 49, no. 3: e70046.
- Sharma, C., and S. Kushwah. 2025. "Mapping the Theory of Consumption Values: A Systematic Review Using the TCCM Approach." *Journal of Consumer Behaviour* 24, no. 2: 562–610.
- Sharma, D., R. Taggar, S. Bindra, and S. Dhir. 2020. "A Systematic Review of Responsiveness to Develop Future Research Agenda: A TCCM and Bibliometric Analysis." *Benchmarking: An International Journal* 27, no. 9: 2649–2677.
- Sokolova, K., and C. Perez. 2021. "You Follow Fitness Influencers on YouTube. But Do You Actually Exercise? How Parasocial Relationships, and Watching Fitness Influencers, Relate to Intentions to Exercise." *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* 58: 102,276.
- Spörl-Wang, K., F. Krause, and S. Henkel. 2025. "Predictors of Social Media Influencer Marketing Effectiveness: A Comprehensive Literature Review and Meta-Analysis." *Journal of Business Research* 186: 114,991.
- Statista. 2024. "Influencer Marketing in India—Statistics & Facts." March 13, 2024. <https://www.statista.com/topics/9189/influencer-marketing-in-india/#topicOverview>.
- Statista. 2025a. "Worldwide Digital Population as of February 2025." <https://www.statista.com/statistics/617136/digital-population-worldwide/>.
- Statista. 2025b. "South Korea: Willingness to Buy an Influencer Collaboration Product." <https://www.statista.com/statistics/1201278/south-korea-willingness-to-buy-an-influencer-collaboration-product/>.
- Stubb, C., A. G. Nyström, and J. Colliander. 2019. "Influencer Marketing: The Impact of Disclosing Sponsorship Compensation Justification on Sponsored Content Effectiveness." *Journal of Communication Management* 23, no. 2: 109–122.
- Tan, G. W. H., E. C. X. Aw, T. H. Cham, et al. 2023. "Metaverse in Marketing and Logistics: The State of the Art and the Path Forward." *Asia Pacific Journal of Marketing and Logistics* 35, no. 12: 2932–2946.
- Tanwar, A. S., H. Chaudhry, and M. K. Srivastava. 2022. "Trends in Influencer Marketing: A Review and Bibliometric Analysis." *Journal of Interactive Advertising* 22, no. 1: 1–27.
- Tham, A., S. H. Chen, and L. Durbidge. 2024. "A Pentadic Analysis of TikTok Marketing in Tourism: The Case of Penang, Malaysia." *Tourist Studies* 24, no. 1: 75–103.

- Thelwall, M., E. Stuart, A. Mas-Bleda, M. Makita, and M. Abdoli. 2022. "I'm Nervous About Sharing This Secret With You: YouTube Influencers Generate Strong Parasocial Interactions by Discussing Personal Issues." *Journal of Data and Information Science* 7, no. 2: 31–56.
- Tian, Z., R. Dew, and R. Iyengar. 2024. "Mega or Micro? Influencer Selection Using Follower Elasticity." *Journal of Marketing Research* 61, no. 3: 472–495.
- Torres, P., M. Augusto, and M. Matos. 2019. "Antecedents and Outcomes of Digital Influencer Endorsement: An Exploratory Study." *Psychology & Marketing* 36, no. 12: 1267–1276.
- Uzunoglu, E., and S. M. Kip. 2014. "Brand Communication Through Digital Influencers: Leveraging Blogger Engagement." *International Journal of Information Management* 34, no. 5: 592–602.
- Van der Bend, D. L., N. Gijssman, T. Bucher, V. A. Shrewsbury, H. van Trijp, and E. van Kleef. 2023. "Can I@ Handle It? The Effects of Sponsorship Disclosure in TikTok Influencer Marketing Videos With Different Product Integration Levels on Adolescents' Persuasion Knowledge and Brand Outcomes." *Computers in Human Behavior* 144: 107723.
- Van Eck, N., and L. Waltman. 2010. "Software Survey: VOSviewer, a Computer Program for Bibliometric Mapping." *Scientometrics* 84, no. 2: 523–538.
- van Reijmersdal, E. A., and S. van Dam. 2020. "How Age and Disclosures of Sponsored Influencer Videos Affect Adolescents' Knowledge of Persuasion and Persuasion." *Journal of Youth and Adolescence* 49, no. 7: 1531–1544.
- Villamediana-Pedrosa, J. D., N. Vila-Lopez, and I. Küster-Boluda. 2019. "Secrets to Design an Effective Message on Facebook: An Application to a Touristic Destination Based on Big Data Analysis." *Current Issues in Tourism* 22, no. 15: 1841–1861.
- Vrontis, D., and M. Christofi. 2021. "R&D Internationalization and Innovation: A Systematic Review, Integrative Framework and Future Research Directions." *Journal of Business Research* 128: 812–823.
- Vrontis, D., A. Makrides, M. Christofi, and A. Thrassou. 2021. "Social Media Influencer Marketing: A Systematic Review, Integrative Framework and Future Research Agenda." *International Journal of Consumer Studies* 45, no. 4: 617–644.
- Wang, X., Y. Ding, and Y. Hu. 2025. "The Impact of Face Presence in User-Generated Videos on Consumer Engagement: Insights Into How, When, and Who." *International Journal of Research in Marketing* 42: 1323–1342.
- Wang, X., I. K. W. Lai, Y. Lu, and X. Liu. 2023. "Narrative or Non-Narrative? The Effects of Short Video Content Structure on Mental Simulation and Resort Brand Attitude." *Journal of Hospitality Marketing & Management* 32, no. 5: 593–614.
- Wei, Z., M. Zhang, and T. Qiao. 2022. "Effect of Personal Branding Stereotypes on User Engagement on Short-Video Platforms." *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* 69: 103,121.
- Wen, X., T. Xian, C. Liao, and Z. Huang. 2025. "Is Beauty the Key to Market Entry? Evaluating Influencer Beauty Through Computer Vision and Multimodal Machine Learning." *Journal of Business-to-Business Marketing* 32, no. 2: 247–264.
- Wu, X., and I. K. W. Lai. 2025. "The Distinctiveness of Short Travel Videos Makes Audiences Proud to Forward them." *Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management* 63: 211–219.
- Xiao, M., R. Wang, and S. Chan-Olmsted. 2018. "Factors Affecting YouTube Influencer Marketing Credibility: A Heuristic-Systematic Model." *Journal of Media Business Studies* 15, no. 3: 188–213.
- Xiao, Q., W. Huang, L. Qu, and X. Li. 2025. "The Impact of Multimodal Information Features of Short Sales Videos on Consumer Engagement Behavior: A Multi-Method Approach." *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* 82: 104,136.
- Yang, Q., Q. Han, J. Li, J. Zhu, and Y. Jiang. 2025. "Exploring the Impact of Certainty Language Style in Social Media Influencers-Generated Content on Consumers' Purchase Behavior." *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing* 20, no. 2: 215–231.
- Yang, Q., Y. Wang, Q. Wang, Y. Jiang, and J. Li. 2025. "Harmonizing Sight and Sound: The Impact of Auditory Emotional Arousal, Visual Variation, and Their Congruence on Consumer Engagement in Short Video Marketing." *Journal of Theoretical and Applied Electronic Commerce Research* 20, no. 2: 69.
- Ye, F., L. Ji, Y. Ning, and Y. Li. 2024. "Influencer Selection and Strategic Analysis for Live Streaming Selling." *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* 77: 103673.
- Yin, H., X. Huang, and G. Zhou. 2024. "An Empirical Investigation Into the Impact of Social Media Fitness Videos on Users' Exercise Intentions." *Behavioral Science* 14, no. 3: 157.
- Yong, R. Y. M., B. L. Chua, P. Fakfare, and H. Han. 2024. "Sustainability à la carte: A Systematic Review of Green Restaurant Research (2010–2023)." *Journal of Travel & Tourism Marketing* 41, no. 4: 508–537.
- Yoo, J. J., H. Kim, and S. Choi. 2024. "Expanding Knowledge on Emotional Dynamics and Viewer Engagement: The Role of Travel Influencers on Youtube." *Journal of Innovation & Knowledge* 9, no. 4: 100616.
- Yuan, L., Y. Shi, H. Xia, and Q. Ye. 2025. "Effective Strategies in Short Video Advertising: Leveraging Influencer Endorsements and Discounts." *Industrial Management & Data Systems* 125, no. 4: 1573–1600.
- Zeithaml, V. A., K. Verleye, I. Hatak, M. Koller, and A. Zauner. 2020. "Three Decades of Customer Value Research: Paradigmatic Roots and Future Research Avenues." *Journal of Service Research* 23, no. 4: 409–432.
- Zhang, J., and B. Tian. 2025. "How Social Media Influencer Makes Popular Marketing Videos? An Empirical Analysis From the Multimodal Data." *International Journal of Information Management* 85: 102952.
- Zhang, X., Z. Zhao, and K. Wang. 2024. "The Effects of Live Comments and Advertisements on Social Media Engagement: Application to Short-Form Online Video." *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing* 18, no. 3: 485–505.
- Zhao, J., and D. Zhang. 2024. "Visual Propaganda in Chinese Central and Local News Agencies: A Douyin Case Study." *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications* 11, no. 1: 1–14.
- Zhong, X., J. Wang, and X. Yu. 2023. "Internet Celebrities, Public Opinions and Food System Change in China: A New Conceptual Framework." *International Food and Agribusiness Management Review* 26, no. 3: 467–488.
- Zhou, Q., B. Li, H. Li, and Y. Lei. 2024. "Mere Copycat? The Effects of Human Versus Human-Like Virtual Influencers on Brand Endorsement Effectiveness: A Moderated Serial-Mediation Model." *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services* 76: 103610.
- Zimmermann, D., C. Noll, L. Gräßer, et al. 2022. "Influencers on YouTube: A Quantitative Study on Young People's Use and Perception of Videos About Political and Societal Topics." *Current Psychology* 41: 6808–6824.

Supporting Information

Additional supporting information can be found online in the Supporting Information section. **Appendix S1:** Different domains of theories. **Appendix S2:** Procedure for expert interview coding and analysis. **Appendix S3:** Demographics of experts (social media influencers) interview. **Appendix S4:** Thematic coding. **Appendix S5:** Expert mapping. **Appendix S6:** Thematic analysis of expert interviews. **Appendix S7:** Methodological classification.